“Śrī Caitanya-caritāmṛta”

Ādi-līlā

Chapter 7

Setting Forth the Account of the Pañca-tattva

(English translation from the Bengali, following the Gauḍīya Maṭha edition and the Anubhāṣya, 2026)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya

Summary. This seventh chapter describes the glory of the Pañca-tattva. Kṛṣṇa Caitanya, who comprises the five *tattvas*, descended and gave the world the holy name and prema, and a great flood of prema arose. Several kinds of sophists (*kutārkikas*) — the Māyāvādīs, the blasphemers and others — fled from that flood. Wishing to deliver them, Mahāprabhu accepted sannyāsa and, by preaching pure devotion, drew all those people to His feet. He also wished to deliver the Māyāvādī sannyāsīs living in Kāśī. At the entreaty of the devotees He met all those sannyāsīs together in the house of a certain brāhmaṇa in Vārāṇasī-dhāma. First He showed them the majesty of His own true nature (*svarūpa*) and so won their faith. Then, answering their questions, He showed that the doctrine of Māyāvāda has no foundation and pointed out every kind of fault in the views of Śrī Śaṅkarācārya. By the strength of the *sukṛti* they gained by seeing Bhagavān, He brought them onto the path of bhakti and bestowed His mercy on them.

A description of the great magnanimity of Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya —

অগত্যৈকগতিং নত্বা হীনার্থাধিকসাধকম্ ।
শ্রীচৈতন্যং লিখ্যতেঽস্য প্রেমভক্তিবদান্যতা ॥ ১ ॥

agaty-eka-gatiṁ natvā
of the shelterless the only shelter having bowed
hīnārthādhika-sādhakam
to the deprived the highest who grants
śrī-caitanyaṁ likhyate 'sya
to Śrī Caitanya is written His
prema-bhakti-vadānyatā
in giving prema-bhakti magnanimity

1 I bow to Śrī Caitanya, the only refuge of those who have no other refuge, who gives the highest treasure to those bereft of every good. Now I write of the magnanimity with which He bestows love and devotion for Kṛṣṇa.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
I bow down to Śrī Caitanya, the refuge of those who have no other refuge — that is, of the *akiñcanas* — who grants the greatest goal to people bereft of the highest goal (*paramārtha*). And I describe the magnanimity with which He gives prema-bhakti.

Anubhāṣya.
agaty-eka-gatiṁ (the one, incomparable refuge of the *agati*, those who have no other refuge), **hīnārthādhika-** (to those who are *hīna-artha* — bereft of *artha*, that is, of the highest goal, deprived of it — that which is beyond all [*adhika*], the greatest: love for Kṛṣṇa, the fifth goal of human life) **sādhakam** (the giver) **śrī-caitanyaṁ natvā** (having bowed down), **asya** (of this Bhagavān, Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya) **prema-bhakti-vadānyatā** (the great compassion of granting prema-bhakti for Kṛṣṇa) **likhyate** (is described).

জয় জয় মহাপ্রভু শ্রীকৃষ্ণচৈতন্য ।
তাঁহার চরণাশ্রিত সেই বড় ধন্য ॥ ২ ॥

jaya jaya mahāprabhu śrī-kṛṣṇa-caitanya
glory glory to Mahāprabhu Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya
tāṁhāra caraṇāśrita sei baḍa dhanya
His at the feet sheltered he greatly blessed

2 Glory, glory to Mahāprabhu Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya! Whoever takes shelter at His feet is truly blessed.

Of the six tattvas in the verse "vande gurūn…," apart from guru-tattva, the examination of the Pañca-tattva begins; though without difference, it is fivefold for the tasting of rasa —

পূর্ব্বে গুর্ব্বাদি ছয় তত্ত্বে কৈল নমস্কার ।
গুরুতত্ত্ব কহিয়াছি, এবে পাঁচের বিচার ॥ ৩ ॥

pūrve gurvādi chaya tattve kaila namaskāra
earlier the guru and the rest six to the truths I made obeisance
guru-tattva kahiyāchi, ebe pāṁcera vicāra
the truth of the guru I have told now of the five the consideration

3 At the beginning I offered obeisance to the six truths, headed by the guru. I have spoken of the truth of the guru; now I shall consider the other five.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
In the first chapter I described *guru-tattva*, dividing it into the *dīkṣā-guru* and the *śikṣā-guru*. The six *tattvas* are those named in the verse "*vande gurūn īśa-bhaktān*…." Now, in this verse, setting *guru-tattva* aside, I examine the remaining five *tattvas*.

পঞ্চতত্ত্ব অবতীর্ণ চৈতন্যের সঙ্গে ।
পঞ্চতত্ত্ব লঞা করেন সংকীর্ত্তন-রঙ্গে ॥ ৪ ॥

pañca-tattva avatīrṇa caitanyera saṅge
the five truths descended Caitanya with
pañca-tattva lañā karena saṅkīrtana-raṅge
the five truths taking He performs of saṅkīrtana in the joy

4 The five truths descended together with Śrī Caitanya, and with them He delights in saṅkīrtana.

পঞ্চতত্ত্ব — এক-বস্তু, নাহি কিছু ভেদ ।
রস আস্বাদিতে তত্ত্ব বিবিধ বিভেদ ॥ ৫ ॥

pañca-tattva — eka-vastu, nāhi kichu bheda
the five truths one substance there is not any difference
rasa āsvādite tattva vividha vibheda
rasa to taste the truth manifold distinctions

5 The five truths are one substance; there is no difference between them at all. Yet to taste rasa, the one truth appears in different forms.

Anubhāṣya.

The Reality possessed of potency (*śaktimān vastu*) is manifest as the Pañca-tattva, recognised through five different kinds of pastimes. In substance it has no duality and so is one, yet it is full of fivefold variety. This variety is a distinctive feature of the pastimes: unlike a dry existence without taste, it serves the sweetness of rasa. The *śruti* says: "His supreme potency is heard to be manifold indeed."[6] From these words it follows that the distinctions of the many potencies of the Reality, the non-dual Knowledge (*advaya-jñāna*), exist eternally.

In the Pañca-tattva — Śrī Gaurāṅga, Nityānanda, Advaita, Gadādhara, Śrīvāsa and the others — there is no difference whatsoever in substance. But for the tasting of rasa this *tattva*, full of varied pastimes, is distinguished in five ways: "*bhakta-rūpa*," "*bhakta-svarūpa*," "*bhaktāvatāra*," "*bhakta-śakti*" and "*śuddha-bhakta*." Of these five *tattvas*, the "*bhakta-rūpa*," the "*bhakta-svarūpa*" and the "*bhaktāvatāra*" are the Prabhu, the Viṣṇu-*tattva*, in the forms of "*svayam*," "*prakāśa*" and "*aṁśa*." The "*bhakta-śakti*" and the "*śuddha-bhakta*" are the *tattva* of potency: it is included within the Viṣṇu-*tattva*, rests on Him as its shelter and is nondifferent from Him. Therefore everything that serves rasa (*rasopakaraṇa*) is nondifferent from the Reality and intimately united with the Form full of rasa; in substance they cannot differ from one another. If, of the two — the "worshipper" and the "One who is worshipped" — one is separated or absent, there can be no pastimes of tasting rasa.

Explanation of the last of the fourteen opening verses of Ādi — (a verse from the diary of Śrī Rūpa Gosvāmī)[7]

পঞ্চতত্ত্বাত্মকং কৃষ্ণং ভক্তরূপস্বরূপকম্ ।
ভক্তাবতারং ভক্তাখ্যং নমামি ভক্তশক্তিকম্ ॥ ৬ ॥

pañca-tattvātmakaṁ kṛṣṇaṁ
of five truths composed Kṛṣṇa
bhakta-rūpa-svarūpakam
devotee in form devotee in essence
bhaktāvatāraṁ bhaktākhyaṁ
the devotee-avatāra called a devotee
namāmi bhakta-śaktikam
I bow to the devotional potency

6 "I bow to Kṛṣṇa, who is manifest as five truths — the Pañca-tattva: as a devotee in form and a devotee in essence, as the incarnation of a devotee, as the one called a devotee, and as the potency of devotion." (Śrī Rūpa Gosvāmī)[1]

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
I bow down to Śrī Kṛṣṇa, who comprises the five *tattvas*: Kṛṣṇa's *bhakta-rūpa*, *bhakta-svarūpa*, *bhakta-avatāra*, *bhakta* and *bhakta-śakti*.

Anubhāṣya.
bhakta-rūpa-svarūpakam (Him whose form [*rūpa*] is Śrī Gaura, full of a devotee's feelings, with a pure body, intent on tasting Himself, and whose *svarūpa* is Nityānanda, who has taken the form of a brother), **bhaktāvatāraṁ** (Advaita), **bhaktākhyaṁ** (Śrīvāsa and others, who abide in *śānta*, *dāsya* and the other *rasas*), **bhakta-śaktikam** (Śrī Gadādhara, Dāmodara, Rāmānanda and others), **pañca-tattvātmakaṁ** (Him whose very self, the *svarūpa*, is the five *tattvas*) **kṛṣṇaṁ** (Kṛṣṇa Caitanya-deva) **namāmi**.

Only Śrī Nanda-nandana, the svayaṁ-rūpa, is the Lord of all —

স্বয়ং ভগবান্ কৃষ্ণ একলে ঈশ্বর ।
অদ্বিতীয়, নন্দাত্মজ, রসিক-শেখর ॥ ৭ ॥

svayaṁ bhagavān kṛṣṇa ekale īśvara
Himself Bhagavān Kṛṣṇa the one Lord
advitīya, nandātmaja, rasika-śekhara
without a second Nanda's son of rasikas the crown

7 Kṛṣṇa is Bhagavān Himself, the one Lord of all. He has no equal; He is the son of Nanda and the crown of all who relish rasa.

All the Viṣṇus, the Vaiṣṇavas and everything that serves in the dhāma, the jīvas and pradhāna — all are Kṛṣṇa's servants —

রাসাদি-বিলাসী, ব্রজললনা-নাগর ।
আর যত সব দেখ, — তাঁর পরিকর ॥ ৮ ॥

rāsādi-vilāsī, vrajalalanā-nāgara
of the rāsa and other pastimes the enjoyer of the maidens of Vraja the lover
āra yata saba dekha, — tāṁra parikara
others as many all you see His associates

8 He enjoys the rāsa dance and His other pastimes and is the beloved of the maidens of Vraja; all the others you see are His associates.

That same Kṛṣṇa is Gaura —

সেই কৃষ্ণ অবতীর্ণ শ্রীকৃষ্ণচৈতন্য ।
সেই পরিকরগণ সঙ্গে সব ধন্য ॥ ৯ ॥

sei kṛṣṇa avatīrṇa śrī-kṛṣṇa-caitanya
that Kṛṣṇa has descended as Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya
sei parikara-gaṇa saṅge saba dhanya
those associates with Him all blessed

9 That same Kṛṣṇa has descended as Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya, and with Him have come all those associates, every one of them blessed.

Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya is the Lord of all, and yet He is full of the mood of being subordinate —

একলা ঈশ্বর-তত্ত্ব চৈতন্য-ঈশ্বর ।
ভক্তভাবময় তাঁর শুদ্ধ কলেবর ॥ ১০ ॥

ekalā īśvara-tattva caitanya-īśvara
alone the Lord-truth Caitanya the Lord
bhakta-bhāvamaya tāṁra śuddha kalevara
of a devotee's sentiment full His pure body

10 Lord Caitanya alone is the Supreme Lord, yet His pure, spiritual body is filled with the sentiment of a devotee.

Anubhāṣya.

The *śruti* mantra "The eternal among the eternals, the conscious among the conscious"[8] points to countless spiritual entities, and their one Supreme Lord is Śrī Caitanya-deva. The Māyāvādīs try to merge the atomic particles of spiritual potency with the all-pervading Spirit (*vibhu-cit*), and so they fall into error; this verse is presented to dispel it. Śrī Caitanya-deva is nondifferent from Vrajendranandana, yet, regarding Him (Kṛṣṇa) as the One to be worshipped, He assumes a form full of the mood of serving Him. Let no one, then, consider this form of Bhagavān an object of material enjoyment, or count it among the jīvas within the material world. That is why Śrī Caitanya's form has not been called merely the form of a *sādhaka* within the material world. It is manifest in *viśuddha-sattva*, and so this form of rasa is recognised only in a heart made bright by *sattva*. Śrī Caitanya-deva is the Supreme Lord Himself, and yet He displays pastimes befitting a servant, not the pastimes of an enjoyer. To see His holy form, with a vision darkened by *tamas*, as some instrument engaged in gratifying the senses is forbidden.

Kṛṣṇa descends as Gaura "in the form of a devotee" only to taste His own sweetness —

কৃষ্ণমাধুর্য্যের এক অদ্ভুত স্বভাব ।
আপনা আস্বাদিতে কৃষ্ণ করে ভক্তভাব ॥ ১১ ॥

kṛṣṇa-mādhuryera eka adbhuta svabhāva
of Kṛṣṇa's sweetness one wondrous property
āpanā āsvādite kṛṣṇa kare bhakta-bhāva
Himself to taste Kṛṣṇa takes on a devotee's sentiment

11 Kṛṣṇa's sweetness has one wondrous property: to taste Himself, He takes on the sentiment of His own devotee.

Anubhāṣya.

Kṛṣṇa, the shelter of all sweetness, has one unprecedented disposition of heart: though He Himself is the *viṣaya-vigraha*, He accepts the mood of the *āśraya*, the worshipper, and becomes absorbed in tasting service to the *viṣaya*. Yet Śrī Caitanya-deva is not merely a form full of the mood of the *āśraya*: He is the *svayaṁ-rūpa*, the Reality Himself.

Nitāi is the "bhakta-svarūpa," Advaita the "bhaktāvatāra" —

ইথে ভক্তভাব ধরে চৈতন্য গোসাঞি ।
'ভক্তস্বরূপ' তাঁর নিত্যানন্দ-ভাই ॥ ১২ ॥

ithe bhakta-bhāva dhare caitanya gosāñi
therefore a devotee's sentiment takes Caitanya Gosāñi
'bhakta-svarūpa' tāṁra nityānanda-bhāi
'devotee in essence' His Nityānanda the brother

12 That is why Caitanya Gosāñi appears in the mood of a devotee, and His brother Nityānanda is the devotee in essence (*bhakta-svarūpa*).

'ভক্ত-অবতার' তাঁর আচার্য্য-গোসাঞি ।
এই তিন তত্ত্ব সবে প্রভু করি' গাই ॥ ১৩ ॥

'bhakta-avatāra' tāṁra ācārya-gosāñi
'the devotee-avatāra' His the Ācārya Gosāñi
ei tina tattva sabe prabhu kari' gāi
these three truths all as Lord holding we sing

13 Advaita Ācārya is His incarnation as a devotee (*bhakta-avatāra*). These three truths we all glorify as the Lord — as Prabhu.

Nitāi and Advaita — Gaura is the Lord even of these two Lords —

এক মহাপ্রভু, আর প্রভু দুইজন ।
দুই প্রভু সেবে মহাপ্রভুর চরণ ॥ ১৪ ॥

eka mahāprabhu, āra prabhu duijana
one Mahāprabhu and Prabhus two
dui prabhu seve mahāprabhura caraṇa
the two Prabhus serve Mahāprabhu's feet

14 One is Mahāprabhu, and the other two are Prabhus; the two Prabhus serve the feet of Mahāprabhu.

Three tattvas are the worshipped, and the fourth and fifth tattvas are the worshippers —

এই তিন তত্ত্ব, — 'সর্ব্বারাধ্য' করি' মানি ।
চতুর্থ যে ভক্ততত্ত্ব — 'আরাধক' করি' জানি ॥ ১৫ ॥

ei tina tattva, — 'sarvārādhya' kari' māni
these three truths 'worshipable by all' as we accept
caturtha ye bhakta-tattva — 'ārādhaka' kari' jāni
the fourth which the devotee-truth 'worshipper' as we know

15 These three truths we accept as worshipable by all; the fourth, the truth of the devotee, we know as the worshipper.

Anubhāṣya.
From the description of the true nature of the Pañca-tattva we can understand that Śrī Mahāprabhu alone is the highest Truth (*para-tattva*), and that Śrī Nityānanda and Advaita Prabhu are the "Īśvara-*tattva*" subordinate to Him. The Supreme Lord and the two manifestations of the Lord are all *para-tattva*, and all of Them are worshipped by every other *tattva*. The fourth, the *tattva* of the pure devotee (*śuddha-bhakta*), and the fifth, the *tattva* of the intimate devotee (*antaraṅga-bhakta*), are both *tattvas* of "worshippers." The two *tattvas* who are "worshipped" appear in the form of servants: though the two *tattvas* of "worshippers" revere Them, They Themselves abide in the service of Śrī Gaurāṅga, the One who is served.

Śrīvāsa and others — the tattva of the devotee —

শ্রীবাসাদি যত কোটি কোটি ভক্তগণ ।
'শুদ্ধভক্ত'-তত্ত্বমধ্যে তাঁ-সবার গণন ॥ ১৬ ॥

śrīvāsādi yata koṭi koṭi bhakta-gaṇa
Śrīvāsa and others all millions millions devotees
‘śuddha-bhakta’-tattva-madhye tāṁ-sabāra gaṇana
‘pure devotee’-truth within of them all the counting

16 The countless millions of devotees headed by Śrīvāsa are all counted among the pure devotees (*śuddha-bhakta*).

Gadādhara and others — the tattva of potency —

গদাধর-পণ্ডিতাদি প্রভুর ‘শক্তি’-অবতার ।
‘অন্তরঙ্গ-ভক্ত’ করি’ গণন যাঁহার ॥ ১৭ ॥

gadādhara-paṇḍitādi prabhura ‘śakti’-avatāra
Gadādhara Paṇḍita and others the Lord’s ‘potency’-avatāras
‘antaraṅga-bhakta’ kari’ gaṇana yāṁhāra
‘intimate devotees’ as counting of whom

17 Gadādhara Paṇḍita and others are incarnations of the Lord’s potency (*śakti*); they are counted as His intimate devotees.

Anubhāṣya.

The *tattvas* of the intimate devotee and of the pure devotee differ in this way: the *tattva* of potency abides in *madhura-rasa*, and in *vātsalya*, *sakhya* and *dāsya-rasa*. If one compares them impartially, the potencies are higher than the devotees, and therefore Śrī Gaurasundara’s intimate servants are the devotees eternally sheltered in *madhura-rasa*. The servants of Śrī Nityānanda and Śrī Advaita generally abide in *vātsalya*, *sakhya*, *dāsya* and *śānta-rasa*. But when these pure devotees come to feel intense love for Śrī Gaurasundara, they take shelter of *madhura-rasa* under the guidance of the intimate devotees. This is made clear at the beginning of Śrī Ṭhākura Mahāśaya’s *Prārthanā*: “When will my body thrill as I say ‘Gaurāṅga’? When will tears flow from my eyes as I say ‘Hari, Hari’? When will Nitāicānd be merciful to me? When will my desire for worldly life become insignificant? When will my mind become pure, giving up the objects of the senses? When will I see Śrī Vṛndāvana? When will I yearn for the feet of Rūpa and Raghunātha? When will I understand the love of the Divine Couple?”

Describing how the “*śuddha-bhakta*” and the “*antaraṅga-bhakta*” differ, Śrī Rūpapāda in his book *Upadeśāmṛta* depicted the steps by which the practicing jīva

rises higher and higher: “Of all who perform karma, the knowers (*jñānīs*) are dearer to Hari — so it is said everywhere. Dearer than they are those who have left knowledge behind and are wholly given to bhakti. Dearer than these are those fixed in prema alone. Dearer than they are the lotus-eyed cowherd girls, and dearer even than they is Rādhikā, the most beloved. And just as dear to Him is this pond of Hers. What wise person would not take shelter of it?” (*Upadeśāmṛta* 10)

Of the five *tattvas* of the Pañca-tattva, two are potency (*śakti*) and three are the possessor of potency (*śaktimān*). The pure devotees and the intimate devotees are the two kinds of potency. Those who are free of other desires and do not cover their pure inclination to serve Kṛṣṇa with the covering of karma or jñāna are *śuddha-bhaktas*. The devotees wholly devoted to Kṛṣṇa (*aikāntika*) who have taken shelter in *madhura-rasa* alone are the *antaraṅga-bhaktas*. *Madhura-rasa* includes *vātsalya*, *sakhya* and *dāsya*. The *antaraṅga-bhakta* is a special kind of *śuddha-bhakta*.

With the four tattvas the Lord plays, preaches, tastes and gives —

যাঁ-সবা লঞা প্রভুর নিত্য বিহার ।
যাঁ-সবা লঞা প্রভুর কীর্ত্তন-প্রচার ॥ ১৮ ॥

যাঁ-সবা লঞা করেন প্রেম আস্বাদন ।
যাঁ-সবা লঞা দান করে প্রেমধন ॥ ১৯ ॥

yāṁ-sabā lañā prabhura nitya vihāra
with whom all taking the Lord’s eternal pastimes
yāṁ-sabā lañā prabhura kīrtana-pracāra
with whom all taking the Lord’s of kīrtana spreading
yāṁ-sabā lañā karena prema āsvādana
with whom all taking He does of prema tasting
yāṁ-sabā lañā dāna kare prema-dhana
with whom all taking giving He makes prema’s treasure

18–19 With them the Lord enjoys His eternal pastimes, with them He spreads the kīrtana, with them He tastes prema, and with them He gives away the treasure of prema.

Anubhāṣya.

Śrī Mahāprabhu, together with all of them — His *prakāśa*, the avatāra of His *puruṣa-avatāra*, the intimate devotees and the pure devotees — Himself eternally plays by tasting prema, and gives prema to the world by preaching kīrtana.

The five tattvas together eternally taste and distribute the rasa of love for Kṛṣṇa —

সেই পঞ্চতত্ত্ব মিলি' পৃথিবী আসিয়া ।
পূর্ব্ব-প্রেমভাণ্ডারের মুদ্রা উঘাড়িয়া ॥ ২০ ॥

পাঁচে মিলি' লুটে প্রেম, করে আস্বাদন ।
যত যত পিয়ে, তৃষ্ণা বাড়ে অনুক্ষণ ॥ ২১ ॥

sei pañca-tattva mili' pṛthivī āsiyā
those five truths together to the earth coming
pūrva-premabhāṇḍārera mudrā ughāḍiyā
of the ancient storehouse of prema the seal breaking open
pāṁce mili' luṭe prema, kare āsvādana
the five together plunder prema do tasting
yata yata piye, tṛṣṇā bāḍe anukṣaṇa
as much as much they drink thirst grows every moment

20–21 Coming to earth together, the five truths broke the seal of the ancient storehouse of prema. Together they plunder that love and taste it, and the more they drink, the more their thirst grows at every moment.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Śrī Kṛṣṇa's own pastimes are the storehouse of prema. That storehouse had indeed come into the world, but its doors were locked and sealed. In the avatāra of Śrī Caitanya the five *tattvas* together broke that seal, opened the doors and, plundering prema, tasted it.

পুনঃ পুনঃ পিয়াইয়া হয় মহামত্ত ।
নাচে, কান্দে, হাসে, গায়, যৈছে মদমত্ত ॥ ২২ ॥

punaḥ punaḥ piyāiyā haya mahāmatta
again again giving to drink become greatly maddened
nāce, kānde, hāse, gāya, yaiche mada-matta
they dance weep laugh sing like the intoxicated

22 Again and again they give it to others to drink and grow wild with love; they dance, weep, laugh and sing as though intoxicated.

In distributing love for Kṛṣṇa there is no considering who is fit and who is unfit —

পাত্রাপাত্র-বিচার নাহি, নাহি স্থানাস্থান ।
যেই যাঁহা পায়, তাঁহা করে প্রেমদান ॥ ২৩ ॥

pātrāpātra-vicāra nāhi, nāhi sthānāsthāna
fit and unfit consideration there is not there is not proper place and improper
yei yāṁhā pāya, tāṁhā kare prema-dāna
whoever wherever is found there they make of prema the gift

23 They make no distinction between the fit and the unfit, nor between a proper place and an improper one: wherever they find anyone, there they give prema.

Distributing prema makes it increase rather than diminish —

লুটিয়া, খাইয়া, দিয়া, ভাণ্ডার উজাড়ে ।
আশ্চর্য্য ভাণ্ডার, প্রেম শতগুণ বাড়ে ॥ ২৪ ॥

luṭiyā, khāiyā, diyā, bhāṇḍāra ujāḍe
plundering eating giving the storehouse they empty
āścarya bhāṇḍāra, prema śata-guṇa bāḍe
wondrous storehouse prema a hundredfold grows

24 Plundering, tasting and giving, they empty the storehouse; yet so wondrous is this storehouse that the prema in it grows a hundredfold.

The world drowns in the flood of prema —

উছলিল প্রেমবন্যা চৌদিকে বেড়ায় ।
স্ত্রী, বৃদ্ধ, বালক, যুবা, সবারে ডুবায় ॥ ২৫ ॥

uchalila prema-vanyā caudike veḍāya
surged of prema the flood on all sides spreads
strī, vṛddha, bālaka, yuvā, sabāre ḍubāya
women old men boys youths all it drowns

25 The flood of prema surged and spread on every side, drowning everyone — women and old men, boys and youths.

সজ্জন, দুর্জ্জন, পঙ্গু, জড়, অন্ধগণ ।
প্রেমবন্যায় ডুবাইল জগতের জন ॥ ২৬ ॥

saj-jana, durjana, paṅgu, jaḍa, andha-gaṇa
the good the wicked the lame the dull the blind
prema-vanyāya ḍubāila jagatera jana
in the flood of prema drowned of the world the people

26 The good and the wicked, the lame, the dull and the blind — the flood of prema engulfed all the people of the world.

Immersed in the rasa of love for Kṛṣṇa, the jīva is rid of the seed of karma —

জগৎ ডুবিল, জীবের হইল বীজ নাশ ।
তাহা দেখি' পাঁচ জনের পরম উল্লাস ॥ ২৭ ॥

jagat ḍubila, jīvera haila bīja nāśa
the world drowned of the jīvas became the seed destroyed
tāhā dekhi' pāṁca janera parama ullāsa
that seeing of the five persons supreme joy

27 The world was drowned, and the seed of the jīvas' bondage was destroyed. Seeing this, the five felt the highest joy.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

When the storehouse of prema was thrown open, the flood of the rasa of prema drowned the whole world with tremendous force. In it perished the seed from which the bondage of ignorance (*avidyā*) grows in the conditioned jīvas — their forgetfulness that they are Kṛṣṇa's servants.

Anubhāṣya.

In the Lord's marginal potency, called the *jīva-śakti*, together with the endeavour turned towards Kṛṣṇa there also lies, in unmanifest form, the seed of the desire to enjoy — aversion to Kṛṣṇa. This seed of desire, born of the tree of *saṁsāra*, is watered by the flow of time, and day after day it binds the conditioned jīva with all kinds of bonds of enjoyment and torments him with the threefold miseries. A seed buried in the soil will not sprout if water submerges it. Just so, in the flood of prema — the bottomless waters of the ocean of service to Bhagavān — the seeds of the desire to enjoy anything other than service to Kṛṣṇa were drowned and destroyed, and no sprouts of desire could arise from them any longer. Śrī Caitanyacandra descended in the form of the Pañca-tattva, and the purpose of His descent was fulfilled; seeing this, all were filled with joy. Śrīmat Prabodhānanda Sarasvatī, the *tridaṇḍipāda*, described this in his book *Śrī Caitanya-candrāmṛta*: "When Caitanyacandra revealed the supreme path of *bhakti-yoga*, the worldly gave up talk of wives, sons and the like; the learned gave up disputes over the *śāstras*; the kings of yogīs gave up the hardship of restraining the breath; ascetics gave up their austerities; and sannyāsīs gave up the practice of knowledge. No other rasa remained."

The rain of prema increases the rasa of prema —

যত যত প্রেমবৃষ্টি করে পঞ্চজন ।
তত তত বাড়ে জল, ব্যাপে ত্রিভুবন ॥ ২৮ ॥

yata yata prema-vṛṣṭi kare pañca-jana
as much as much rain of prema make the five persons
tata tata bāḍe jala, vyāpe tri-bhuvana
so much so much rises the water pervades the three worlds

28 The more the five pour down the rain of prema, the higher the waters rise, until they fill the three worlds.

Those deprived of the rasa of love for Kṛṣṇa —

মায়াবাদী, কর্ম্মনিষ্ঠ, কুতার্কিকগণ ।
নিন্দক, পাষণ্ডী, যত পড়ুয়া অধম ॥ ২৯ ॥

সেই সব মহাদক্ষ ধাঞা পলাইল ।
সেই বন্যা তা-সবারে ছুঁইতে নারিল ॥ ৩০ ॥

māyāvādī, karma-niṣṭha, kutārkika-gaṇa
Māyāvādīs those devoted to karma the false logicians
nindaka, pāṣaṇḍī, yata paḍuyā adhama
blasphemers pāṣaṇḍīs all students the lowest
sei saba mahādakṣa dhāñā palāila
they all very clever running fled
sei vanyā tā-sabāre chuṁite nārila
that flood them all to touch could not

29–30 But the Māyāvādīs, those devoted to fruitive work, the false logicians, the blasphemers, the pāṣaṇḍīs and the lowest of students — all these, being very clever, ran away, and the flood could not touch them.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

The Māyāvādīs are Prakāśānanda and the other sannyāsīs. In every matter that is real they raise disputes about "*māyā*"! They call Brahman "beyond māyā," yet they make Īśvara "an associate of *māyā*" and call the bodies of all Īśvara's avatāras "made of māyā." They say that māyā takes part in the very constitution of the jīva, that is, that every notion of "I" in the jīva is made by māyā. From this they conclude that once the jīva is liberated, no state that could be called "the pure *jīva*" remains. In other words, they teach that the liberated jīva becomes nondifferent from Brahman.

Those devoted to karma (*karma-niṣṭha*) are Devānanda and other *karmīs* devoid of bhakti, and the *smārtas* dulled by karma — that is, those who declare karma and its fruits to be the chief aim of the jīva.

The sophists are Sārvabhauma and other logicians who deny Īśvara.

The blasphemers are the man whom the Lord chased with a stick, and Gopāla Cāpāla and others who blasphemed the Lord and His devotees.

The *pāṣaṇḍīs* are those who explain other gods as equal to Bhagavān.

The lowly students are those who take learning to be a cause for argument and do not know that learning is the means to attain Īśvara.

The ocean of causeless mercy thinks how to deliver them —

তাহা দেখি’ মহাপ্রভু করেন চিন্তন ।
জগৎ ডুবাইতে আমি করিলুঁ যতন ॥ ৩১ ॥

কেহ কেহ এড়াইল, প্রতিজ্ঞা হইল ভঙ্গ ।
তা-সবা ডুবাইতে পাতিব কিছু রঙ্গ ॥ ৩২ ॥

tāhā dekhi’ mahāprabhu karena cintana
that seeing Mahāprabhu makes reflection
jagat ḍubāite āmi karilum̐ yatana
the world to drown I made effort
keha keha eḍāila, pratijñā haila bhaṅga
some some escaped the vow became broken
tā-sabā ḍubāite pātiba kichu raṅga
them all to drown I shall set some play

31–32 Seeing this, Mahāprabhu reflected: “I tried to drown the whole world, but some have escaped, and My vow has been broken. To drown them too, I shall devise a playful ruse.”

To deliver the fallen jīvas deprived of prema, He accepts sannyāsa —

এত বলি’ মনে কিছু করিয়া বিচার ।
সন্ন্যাস-আশ্রম প্রভু কৈলা অঙ্গীকার ॥ ৩৩ ॥

eta bali’ mane kichu kariyā vicāra
thus saying in the mind some making deliberation
sannyāsa-āśrama prabhu kailā aṅgīkāra
the sannyāsa order the Lord made acceptance

33 Saying this and deliberating within Himself, the Lord accepted the order of sannyāsa.

Anubhāṣya.

One who mistakenly believes that "*māyā*" is present in Bhagavān's being, in His abode, in devotion to Him and in His devotee — though all of these are beyond māyā — is a "Māyāvādī." One who mistakenly believes that these four truths are subject to karma and to enjoying its fruits is "devoted to karma" (*karma-niṣṭha*). People who mistakenly think that in these four truths there is room for argument born of ignorance are "sophists." One who mistakenly thinks that these four truths deserve censure is a "blasphemer." One who mistakenly thinks that other things of māyā are equal to these four truths is a "*pāṣaṇḍī*." And those fond of study who mistakenly think that these four truths are on a par with other objects of material enjoyment are "lowly students." All of them fled, driven by one aim: that the waters of the flood of prema given by Gaurasundara, who is full of love, should in no way touch them. Seeing this, Śrī Mahāprabhu wished to accept the ornament of the fourth *āśrama*. It is highly revered by those people of material nature already mentioned, who turn away from love for Kṛṣṇa and long for the four goals of life (*catur-varga*). He reasoned that in the eyes of these worldly people, bewitched by māyā, the fourth *āśrama* is the desirable ideal.

চব্বিশ বৎসর ছিলা গৃহস্থ-আশ্রমে ।
পঞ্চবিংশতি বর্ষে কৈল যতিধর্ম্মে ॥ ৩৪ ॥

cabbiśa vatsara chilā gṛhastha-āśrame
twenty-four years He remained in the householder order
pañca-viṁśati varṣe kaila yati-dharme
in the twenty-fifth year He took to the renunciant's dharma

34 For twenty-four years He lived as a householder; in His twenty-fifth year He took up the dharma of a renunciant.

Anubhāṣya.

There are four kinds of *āśramas*: *brahmacārī*, *gṛhastha*, *vānaprastha* and *yati*. Each *āśrama* in turn has four divisions. The *Bhāgavatam* says: "*Sāvitrya*, *prājāpatya*, *brāhma* and *bṛhat* [for the *brahmacārīs*]; *vārtā*, *sañcaya*, *śālīna* and *śiloñcha* for the householder; the *vaikhānasas*, *vālakhilyas*, *audumbaras* and *phenapas* in the forest; and for the sannyāsīs, first the *kuṭīcaka*, then the *bahūdaka*, the *haṁsa* and the *niṣkriya*." (*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 3.12.42–43) That is, *brahmacarya* is of four kinds: (1) *sāvitrya*, a *brahmacarya* of three nights, from the *up-*

anayana until the study of the Gāyatrī; (2) *prājāpatya*, a *brahmacarya* in which one keeps vows for a year after the *upanayana*; (3) *brāhma*, a *brahmacarya* from the *upanayana* until the three Vedas have been learned; (4) *bṛhat*, a *brahmacarya* from the *upanayana* until death. The first three are known as "*upakurvāṇa*" and the last as "*naiṣṭhika*." Householders are of four kinds: (1) *vārtā*, who lives by agriculture and other occupations that are not forbidden; (2) *sañcaya*, who lives by performing sacrifices for others and the like; (3) *śālīna*, who lives on what comes unasked; (4) *śiloñchana*, who lives on grains gleaned from the ground. *Vānaprasthas* are of four kinds: (1) the *vaikhānasa*, who lives on what grows without ploughing; (2) the *vālikhilya*, who, on obtaining new grain, gives up what he had stored before; (3) the *auḍumbara*, who, on rising from bed, accepts food brought from whatever direction he first looks; (4) the *phenapa*, who sustains life on fruits that have fallen by themselves. *Sannyāsīs* are of four kinds: (1) the *kuṭīcaka*, chiefly devoted to the duties of his own *āśrama*; (2) the *bahūdaka*, who has given up karma and is chiefly devoted to cultivating knowledge; (3) the *haṁsa*, fixed in the cultivation of knowledge; (4) the *niṣkriya*, a *paramahaṁsa*, or one who has realised the truth.

Sannyāsa is of two kinds, "*dhīra*" and "*narottama*": "One who, detached and freed from bonds, gives up this body, which no longer serves any purpose, without anyone knowing where he has gone, is called '*dhīra*.' And one who, self-possessed, has become disgusted with the world by himself or through another's instruction and, placing Hari in his heart, leaves home, is '*narottama*.'" (*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 1.13.26–27) Śrī Mahāprabhu accepted sannyāsa in the bright fortnight of the month of Māgha in the Śaka year 1432 from Śrī Keśava Bhāratī, a *daṇḍi-svāmī* of the sampradāya of Śrī Śaṅkara, who lived in Kāṭoyā. These sannyāsīs are under the Śṛṅgerī *maṭha* in the south.

The deliverance of those deprived of prema — the karmīs, students, pāṣaṇḍīs, logicians, blasphemers and the rest —

সন্ন্যাস করিয়া প্রভু কৈলা আকর্ষণ।
যতেক পালাঞাছিল তার্কিকাদি গণ ॥ ৩৫ ॥

sannyāsa kariyā prabhu kailā ākarṣaṇa
sannyāsa having taken the Lord made attraction
yateka pālāñāchila tārkikādi gaṇa
all who had fled the logicians and the rest

35 Having taken sannyāsa, the Lord drew to Himself all who had fled — the logicians and the rest.

পড়ুয়া, পাষণ্ডী, কর্ম্মী, নিন্দকাদি যত ।
তারা আসি' প্রভু-পায় হয় অবনত ॥ ৩৬ ॥

paḍuyā, pāṣaṇḍī, karmī, nindakādi yata
students pāṣaṇḍīs karmīs blasphemers and others all
tārā āsi' prabhu-pāya haya avanata
they coming at the Lord's feet become bowed down

36 Students, pāṣaṇḍīs, karmīs, blasphemers and all the others came and bowed down at the Lord's feet.

Anubhāṣya.
See the last part of the *Anubhāṣya* on Ādi 7.33.

They are freed from their offences and gain bhakti —

অপরাধ ক্ষমাইল, ডুবিল প্রেমজলে ।
কেবা এড়াইবে প্রভুর প্রেম-মহাজালে ॥ ৩৭ ॥

aparādha kṣamāila, ḍubila prema-jale
offences He forgave they sank in the waters of prema
kebā eḍāibe prabhura prema-mahājāle
who will escape the Lord's in the great net of prema

37 He forgave their offences, and they sank into the waters of prema. Who can escape the Lord's great net of love?

The Lord devises a means to deliver all jīvas —

সবা নিস্তারিতে প্রভু কৃপা-অবতার ।
সবা নিস্তারিতে করে চাতুরী অপার ॥ ৩৮ ॥

sabā nistārite prabhu kṛpā-avatāra
all to deliver the Lord the avatāra of mercy
sabā nistārite kare cāturī apāra
all to deliver He uses stratagems boundless

38 The Lord is the avatāra of mercy who came to deliver everyone, and to that end He devises countless stratagems.

All people are delivered except the Māyāvādīs of Kāśī —

তবে নিজ ভক্ত কৈল যত ম্লেচ্ছ আদি ।
সবে এড়াইল মাত্র কাশীর মায়াবাদী ॥ ৩৯ ॥

tabe nija bhakta kaila yata mleccha ādi
then His own devotees He made all mlecchas and others
sabe eḍāila mātra kāśīra māyāvādī
all escaped only of Kāśī the Māyāvādīs

39 He made His devotees of all — even the mlecchas and others; only the Māyāvādīs of Kāśī escaped.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
As soon as the Lord accepted sannyāsa, the sophists, those devoted to karma, the blasphemers, the *pāṣaṇḍīs* and the lowly students one after another took shelter at His feet, and even many *mlecchas* accepted His guidance. Only the Māyāvādīs of Vārāṇasī-dhāma, having fled from the flood of prema, remained apart!

Anubhāṣya.
"The Māyāvādīs of Kāśī." People bewildered by knowledge born of the senses say that the world they see with their senses is "created by māyā," since it can be measured by sensory knowledge. There are people skilled in this kind of reasoning: "The Truth (*tattva-vastu*) is beyond māyā, yet in it there is no eternal spiritual variety and no spiritual pastime; it is pure consciousness alone (*cin-mātra*)." They are the "Māyāvādīs of Kāśī." The "Māyāvādīs of Sārnāth," or the "Māyāvādīs of Bodh Gayā," do not accept the māyā of Brahman: in their reasoning, the doctrine that there is nothing but non-spirit (*acin-mātra-vāda*) is established. The "Māyāvādīs of Kāśī" and the Māyāvādīs of other places are all *prakṛti-vādīs*; none of them is a "*brahma-vādī* or *tattva-vādī*." The Māyāvādīs of Kāśī call themselves "*brahma-vādīs*" with their lips, but they do not accept the distinction between Brahman and

prakṛti: following their doctrine of merging (*samanvaya-vāda*), they hold Brahman and māyā to be one and the same. The Māyāvādīs know nothing of bhakti and Yogamāyā, and that is why they are nondevotees, averse to devotion to Kṛṣṇa. In their hearts the Māyāvādīs are convinced that everything said about eternal bhakti, the One who is worshipped and the devotee — all of it is subject to their sense-born knowledge. But in fact, judged by the real truth, such words are worth nothing. However many sophistries and disputes the Māyāvādīs put forward among themselves, they never approach the real truth, and so the Truth and His spiritual variety are not subject to their imaginary reasonings.

বৃন্দাবন যাইতে প্রভু রহিলা কাশীতে ।
মায়াবাদিগণ তাঁরে লাগিলা নিন্দিতে ॥ ৪০ ॥

vṛndāvana yāite prabhu rahilā kāśīte
to Vṛndāvana going the Lord stayed in Kāśī
māyāvādi-gaṇa tāṁre lāgilā nindite
the Māyāvādīs Him began to blaspheme

40 On His way to Vṛndāvana the Lord stayed in Kāśī, and the Māyāvādīs began to blaspheme Him:

The Māyāvādīs blaspheme the Lord —

সন্ন্যাসী হইয়া করেন গায়ন, নাচন ।
না করে বেদান্ত শ্রবণ, করে সংকীর্ত্তন ॥ ৪১ ॥

sannyāsī haiyā karena gāyana, nācana
a sannyāsī being He does singing dancing
nā kare vedānta śravaṇa, kare saṅkīrtana
not does of Vedānta hearing does saṅkīrtana

41 "Though a sannyāsī, He sings and dances. He does not hear Vedānta, but performs saṅkīrtana.

Anubhāṣya.
The *smṛti* enjoins: "The sannyāsī should give up the *tauryatrika* — singing, dancing and playing instruments — and should always study Vedānta." The sannyāsīs of Kāśī saw that Śrī Mahāprabhu did not listen to Śaṅkara's Māyāvāda but, on the

contrary, was absorbed in singing of Kṛṣṇa and so on, and danced overwhelmed with love. Measuring Him by this injunction, they concluded that He did not know the dharma of sannyāsa. Śaṅkara says: "Fortunate indeed are those who wear only a loincloth and always delight in the words of Vedānta."[9] Not seeing this mark in Śrī Mahāprabhu, the Māyāvādī sannyāsīs and the home-bound householders (*gṛhavratas*) blasphemed Him. On the deliverance of the Māyāvādī sannyāsīs of Kāśī, see especially Madhya 25.5–169.

মূর্খ সন্ন্যাসী নিজ-ধর্ম্ম নাহি জানে ।
ভাবুক হইয়া ফেরে ভাবুকের সনে ॥ ৪২ ॥

mūrkha sannyāsī nija-dharma nāhi jāne
a foolish sannyāsī his own dharma not knows
bhāvuka haiyā phere bhāvukera sane
sentimental being He wanders with the sentimentalists together

42 This foolish sannyāsī does not know His own dharma; a sentimentalist Himself, He wanders about with sentimentalists."

এ সব শুনিয়া প্রভু হাসে মনে মনে ।
উপেক্ষা করিয়া কারো না কৈল সম্ভাষণে ॥ ৪৩ ॥

e saba śuniyā prabhu hāse mane mane
this all hearing the Lord smiles in the mind in the mind
upekṣā kariyā kāro nā kaila sambhāṣaṇe
disregard making to anyone not made conversation

43 Hearing all this, the Lord smiled within, and, paying no heed, He spoke with none of them.

The Lord disregards them and goes to Mathurā —

উপেক্ষা করিয়া কৈল মথুরা গমন ।
মথুরা দেখিয়া পুনঃ কৈল আগমন ॥ ৪৪ ॥

upekṣā kariyā kaila mathurā gamana
disregard making He made to Mathurā going
mathurā dekhiyā punaḥ kaila āgamana
Mathurā having seen again He made return

44 Disregarding them, He went on to Mathurā, and after seeing it He came back again.

The Lord stays in Candraśekhara's house —

কাশীতে লেখক শূদ্র-শ্রীচন্দ্রশেখর ।
তাঁর ঘরে রহিলা প্রভু স্বতন্ত্র ঈশ্বর ॥ ৪৫ ॥

kāśīte lekhaka śūdra-śrīcandraśekhara
in Kāśī the scribe the śūdra Śrī Candraśekhara
tāṁra ghare rahilā prabhu svatantra īśvara
his in the house stayed the Lord the independent Īśvara

45 In Kāśī lived the scribe Śrī Candraśekhara, a śūdra, and the Lord, supremely independent, stayed in his house.

Anubhāṣya.
In the *Śrī Caitanya-candrodaya-nāṭaka* Śrī Candraśekhara is called a "*śaukra-vaidya*" (a Vaidya by birth). In those days the Vaidyas by birth, and every *varṇa* other than the brāhmaṇas by birth, were called "*śūdras*." Later, in the present century, the Kāyasthas, resorting to the purificatory rite for the *vrātyas* (those who have lost the right to initiation), took and are taking the *saṁskāras* of kṣatriyas, and the Vaidyas those of *vaiśyas*. In the families of the Śrī Gauḍīya Vaiṣṇava ācāryas who follow the Vaiṣṇava faith — in the line of Ṭhākura Raghunandana, in the line of Ṭhākura Kṛṣṇadāsa and Navanī Hoḍa, and in the line of Śrī Rasikānanda-deva, the disciple of Śyāmānanda Prabhu — the *upanayana-saṁskāra*, the ideal of brahminhood, has continued for three or four centuries now. To this day they act as *dīkṣā-gurus* for all *varṇas*, brāhmaṇas included, and worship *śālagrāmas* and other Deities.

Leaving the Māyāvādī sannyāsīs, the Lord accepts bhikṣā in the house of

Tapana Miśra —

তপন-মিশ্রের ঘরে ভিক্ষা-নির্ব্বাহণ ।
সন্ন্যাসীর সঙ্গে নাহি মানে নিমন্ত্রণ ॥ ৪৬ ॥

tapana-miśrera ghare bhikṣā-nirvāhaṇa
of Tapana Miśra in the house alms taking
sannyāsīra saṅge nāhi māne nimantraṇa
of sannyāsīs in company not accepts invitation

46 He took His meals at the house of Tapana Miśra and accepted no invitation in the company of the sannyāsīs.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
The Vaidya Candraśekhara was a śūdra by *varṇa*. It is not proper for sannyāsīs to spend the night in a śūdra's house, but Mahāprabhu, out of mercy to him, stayed in his house: for He is the independent Īśvara, and before His mercy all are equal, brāhmaṇa and śūdra alike. He accepted *bhikṣā*, that is, His meals, in the house of Tapana Miśra. And nowhere did He accept invitations together with other sannyāsīs.

Instructions to Śrī Sanātana —

সনাতন গোসাঞি আসি' তাঁহাই মিলিলা ।
তাঁর শিক্ষা লাগি' প্রভু দু-মাস রহিলা ॥ ৪৭ ॥

sanātana gosāñi āsi' tāṁhāi mililā
Sanātana Gosāñi coming there met
tāṁra śikṣā lāgi' prabhu du-māsa rahilā
his instruction for the sake of the Lord two months stayed

47 Sanātana Gosāñi came and met Him there, and to instruct him the Lord stayed two months.

তাঁরে শিক্ষাইল সব বৈষ্ণবের ধর্ম্ম ।
শ্রীভাগবত-আদি শাস্ত্রের যত গূঢ় মর্ম্ম ॥ ৪৮ ॥

tāṁre śikṣāila saba vaiṣṇavera dharma
him He taught all of the Vaiṣṇavas the dharma
śrī bhāgavata-ādi śāstrera yata gūḍha marma
Śrī Bhāgavata and other of the scriptures all secret heart

48 He taught him the whole dharma of the Vaiṣṇavas and all the hidden heart of the *Bhāgavata* and the other scriptures.

The appeal of Candraśekhara and Tapana Miśra —

ইতিমধ্যে চন্দ্রশেখর, মিশ্র-তপন ৷
দুঃখী হঞা প্রভু-পায় কৈল নিবেদন ॥ ৪৯ ॥

itimadhye candraśekhara, miśra-tapana
meanwhile Candraśekhara Miśra Tapana
duḥkhī hañā prabhu-pāya kaila nivedana
grieved being at the Lord's feet made petition

49 Meanwhile Candraśekhara and Tapana Miśra, deeply grieved, came to the Lord's feet with a petition:

কতেক শুনিব প্রভু তোমার নিন্দন!
না পারি সহিতে, এবে ছাড়িব জীবন ॥ ৫০ ॥

kateka śuniba prabhu tomāra nindana!
how much shall we hear O Lord of You the blasphemy
nā pāri sahite, ebe chāḍiba jīvana
not we can bear now we shall give up life

50 "How much longer must we hear You blasphemed, O Lord? We cannot bear it; we would rather give up our lives.

তোমাকে নিন্দয়ে যত সন্ন্যাসীর গণ ৷
শুনিতে না পারি, ফাটে হৃদয়-শ্রবণ ॥ ৫১ ॥

tomāke nindaye yata sannyāsīra gaṇa
You blaspheme all of sannyāsīs the company
śunite nā pāri, phāṭe hṛdaya-śravaṇa
to hear not we can bursts heart and ears

51 All the sannyāsīs revile You, and we cannot listen to it: our hearts and ears are bursting."

ইহা শুনি' রহে প্রভু ঈষৎ হাসিয়া ।
সেইকালে এক বিপ্র মিলিল আসিয়া ॥ ৫২ ॥

ihā śuni' rahe prabhu īṣat hāsiyā
this hearing remains the Lord slightly smiling
sei kāle eka vipra milila āsiyā
at that time one brāhmaṇa met coming

52 Hearing this, the Lord only smiled a little. Just then a brāhmaṇa came to meet Him.

The brāhmaṇa's request —

আসি' নিবেদন করে চরণে ধরিয়া ।
এক বস্তু মাগোঁ, দেহ, প্রসন্ন হইয়া ॥ ৫৩ ॥

āsi' nivedana kare caraṇe dhariyā
coming petition makes the feet clasping
eka vastu māgoṁ, deha, prasanna haiyā
one thing I beg give pleased being

53 He came and, clasping the Lord's feet, made his petition: "I beg one thing of You; be pleased and grant it.

সকল সন্ন্যাসী মুঞি কৈনু নিমন্ত্রণ ।
তুমি যদি আইস, পূর্ণ হয় মোর মন ॥ ৫৪ ॥

sakala sannyāsī muñi kainu nimantraṇa
all sannyāsīs I have made invitation
tumi yadi āisa, pūrṇa haya mora mana
You if come fulfilled becomes my heart

54 I have invited all the sannyāsīs; if You come too, my heart's desire will be fulfilled.

না যাহ সন্ন্যাসী-গোষ্ঠী, ইহা আমি জানি ।
মোরে অনুগ্রহ কর নিমন্ত্রণ মানি' ॥ ৫৫ ॥

nā yāha sannyāsī-goṣṭhī, ihā āmi jāni
not You go sannyāsī-gatherings this I know
more anugraha kara nimantraṇa māni'
to me mercy show the invitation accepting

55 I know that You do not go to gatherings of sannyāsīs; yet be merciful to me and accept my invitation."

The Lord accepts the invitation —

প্রভু হাসি' নিমন্ত্রণ কৈল অঙ্গীকার ।
সন্ন্যাসীরে কৃপা লাগি' এ ভঙ্গী তাঁহার ॥ ৫৬ ॥

prabhu hāsi' nimantraṇa kaila aṅgīkāra
the Lord smiling the invitation made acceptance
sannyāsīre kṛpā lāgi' e bhaṅgī tāṁhāra
to the sannyāsīs mercy for the sake of this gesture His

56 Smiling, the Lord accepted the invitation; He made this gesture to show mercy to the sannyāsīs.

সে বিপ্র জানেন, প্রভু না যা'ন কা'র ঘরে ।
তাঁহার প্রেরণায় তাঁরে অত্যাগ্রহ করে ॥ ৫৭ ॥

se vipra jānena, prabhu nā yā'na kā'ra ghare
that brāhmaṇa knows the Lord not goes to anyone's house
tāṁhāra preraṇāya tāṁre atyāgraha kare
by His inspiration Him great insistence makes

57 The brāhmaṇa knew that the Lord does not go to anyone's house, but, inspired by the Lord Himself, he pressed Him with great insistence.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Even so, the Lord, wishing to bestow mercy on the sannyāsīs, inspired the brāhmaṇa from within his heart, and that is why he made such an insistent request.

The Lord enters the assembly of sannyāsīs —

আর দিনে গেলা প্রভু সে বিপ্র-ভবনে ।
দেখিলেন, বসিয়াছেন সন্ন্যাসীর গণে ॥ ৫৮ ॥

āra dine gelā prabhu se vipra-bhavane
on the next day went the Lord that brāhmaṇa's house
dekhilena, vasiyāchena sannyāsīra gaṇe
He saw are seated of sannyāsīs the company

58 The next day the Lord went to the brāhmaṇa's house and saw the sannyāsīs all seated there.

The Lord's humility —

সবা নমস্করি' গেলা পাদ-প্রক্ষালনে ।
পাদ প্রক্ষালিয়া বসিল সেই স্থানে ॥ ৫৯ ॥

sabā namaskari' gelā pāda-prakṣālane
to all bowing He went to wash the feet
pāda prakṣāliyā vasila sei sthāne
the feet having washed sat in that place

59 Bowing to them all, He went to wash His feet, and when He had washed them He sat down in that very place.

The Lord displays His majesty and bewilders the pāṣaṇḍīs —

বসিয়া করিলা কিছু ঐশ্বর্য্য প্রকাশ ।
মহাতেজোময় বপু কোটীসূর্য্যাভাস ॥ ৬০ ॥

vasiyā karilā kichu aiśvarya prakāśa
sitting He made some of majesty display
mahātejomaya vapu koṭī-sūryābhāsa
greatly effulgent body of millions of suns the splendour

60 As He sat there, He revealed a little of His majesty: His body shone with great effulgence, with the splendour of millions of suns.[2]

প্রভাবে আকর্ষিল সব সন্ন্যাসীর মন ।
উঠিলা সন্ন্যাসী সব ছাড়িয়া আসন ॥ ৬১ ॥

prabhāve ākarṣila saba sannyāsīra mana
by the splendour He attracted all of the sannyāsīs the minds
uṭhilā sannyāsī saba chāḍiyā āsana
rose the sannyāsīs all leaving their seats

61 That splendour drew the minds of all the sannyāsīs, and they all rose from their seats.

The words of Prakāśānanda Sarasvatī —

প্রকাশানন্দ-নামে এক সন্ন্যাসী প্রধান ।
প্রভুকে কহিল কিছু করিয়া সম্মান ॥ ৬২ ॥

prakāśānanda-nāme eka sannyāsī pradhāna
Prakāśānanda by name one sannyāsī chief
prabhuke kahila kichu kariyā sammāna
to the Lord spoke something showing respect

62 The chief among the sannyāsīs, Prakāśānanda by name, addressed the Lord with respect:

ইহাঁ আইস গোসাঞি, শুনহ শ্রীপাদ ।
অপবিত্র স্থানে বৈস, কিবা অবসাদ ॥ ৬৩ ॥

ihāṁ āisa gosāñi, śunaha śrīpāda
here come Gosāñi listen Śrīpāda
apavitra sthāne vaisa, kibā avasāda
in an impure place You sit what dejection

63 "Come here, Gosāñi; listen, Śrīpāda. You are sitting in an impure place — why are You so downcast?"

The Lord's humble words —

প্রভু কহে, — আমি হই হীন-সম্প্রদায় ।
তোমা-সবার সম্প্রদায়ে বসিতে না যুয়ায় ॥ ৬৪ ॥

prabhu kahe, — āmi hai hīna-sampradāya
the Lord says I am of a lower sampradāya
tomā-sabāra sampradāye vasite nā yuyāya
of you all in the assembly to sit not befits

64 The Lord replied, "I belong to a lower sampradāya; it is not fitting for Me to sit in your assembly."

Anubhāṣya.

Among the *daṇḍīs* of the ten names, whose order Śrī Śaṅkarācārya founded, three sampradāyas — "Tīrtha," "Āśrama" and "Sarasvatī" — rank above the sannyāsīs of the other sampradāyas in good conduct and in honour. Śrī Mahāprabhu had accepted sannyāsa in the "Bhāratī" sampradāya, and so He regarded Prakāśānanda Sarasvatī as belonging to a higher sampradāya. Or else: the *brahma-sannyāsīs* themselves consider their social standing high, and so Śrī Mahāprabhu, wishing to show the dharma of a Vaiṣṇava sannyāsī — to seek no honour for oneself (*amānī*) and to give honour to others (*mānada*) — spoke of Himself as belonging to a lower sampradāya. Even today the sannyāsīs of Śaṅkara's sampradāya are unwilling to call other sannyāsīs "*sannyāsīs*": they give them only the title "*brahmacārī*" and fancy themselves "gurus."

Prakāśānanda's question —

আপনে প্রকাশানন্দ হাতেতে ধরিয়া ।
বসাইল সভামধ্যে সম্মান করিয়া ॥ ৬৫ ॥

āpane prakāśānanda hātete dhariyā
himself Prakāśānanda by the hand taking
vasāila sabhā-madhye sammāna kariyā
seated in the midst of the assembly respect showing

65 Then Prakāśānanda himself took Him by the hand and, with respect, seated Him in the midst of the assembly.

পুছিল, তোমার নাম 'শ্রীকৃষ্ণচৈতন্য' ।
কেশব-ভারতীর শিষ্য, তাতে তুমি ধন্য ॥ ৬৬ ॥

puchila, tomāra nāma 'śrī-kṛṣṇa-caitanya'
he asked Your name 'Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya'
keśava-bhāratīra śiṣya, tāte tumi dhanya
of Keśava Bhāratī the disciple therefore You are glorious

66 He asked, "Your name is Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya, is it not? You are a disciple of Keśava Bhāratī, and so You are worthy of glory.

Anubhāṣya.
Keśava Bhāratī — see the *Vaiṣṇava-mañjuṣā-samāhṛti* (part 2).

সাম্প্রদায়িক সন্ন্যাসী তুমি, রহ এই গ্রামে ।
কি কারণে আমা-সবার না কর দর্শনে ॥ ৬৭ ॥

sāmpradāyika sannyāsī tumi, raha ei grāme
of the sampradāya a sannyāsī You You live in this town
ki kāraṇe āmā-sabāra nā kara darśane
for what reason us all not You make seeing

67 You are a sannyāsī of our own sampradāya and You live in this town; why then do You not come to see us?

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

"A sannyāsī of the *sampradāya*": according to the teaching of Śrī Śaṅkarācārya, the brāhmaṇas who accept sannyāsa in the order of the ten names are the world-honoured "Vedic sannyāsīs," that is, genuine sannyāsīs sanctioned by the *śāstras*.

সন্ন্যাসী হইয়া কর নর্ত্তন-গায়ন ।
ভাবুক সব সঙ্গে লঞা করহ কীর্ত্তন ॥ ৬৮ ॥

sannyāsī haiyā kara nartana-gāyana
a sannyāsī being You do dancing and singing
bhāvuka saba saṅge lañā karaha kīrtana
sentimentalists all with taking You do kīrtana

68 Though You are a sannyāsī, You dance and sing, and You take all these sentimentalists with You and perform kīrtana.

বেদান্ত-পঠন, ধ্যান, — সন্ন্যাসীর ধর্ম্ম ।
তাহা ছাড়ি' কর কেনে ভাবুকের কর্ম্ম ॥ ৬৯ ॥

vedānta-paṭhana, dhyāna, — sannyāsīra dharma
Vedānta-study meditation of a sannyāsī the dharma
tāhā chāḍi' kara kene bhāvukera karma
that abandoning You do why of sentimentalists the work

69 The study of Vedānta and meditation are the dharma of a sannyāsī; why do You abandon them and do the work of sentimentalists?

Anubhāṣya.
See the *Anubhāṣya* on Ādi 7.41.

প্রভাবে দেখিয়ে তোমা সাক্ষাৎ নারায়ণ ।
হীনাচার কর কেনে, ইথে কি কারণ ॥ ৭০ ॥

prabhāve dekhiye tomā sākṣāt nārāyaṇa
by Your splendour we see You directly Nārāyaṇa
hīnācāra kara kene, ithe ki kāraṇa
low conduct You do why in this what reason

70 From Your splendour we see that You are Nārāyaṇa Himself; why then do You behave so lowly? What is the reason?"

The Lord describes the glory of the holy name —

প্রভু কহে, — শুন, শ্রীপাদ, ইহার কারণ ।
গুরু মোরে মূর্খ দেখি' করিল শাসন ॥ ৭১ ॥

prabhu kahe, — śuna, śrīpāda, ihāra kāraṇa
the Lord says listen Śrīpāda of this the reason
guru more mūrkha dekhi' karila śāsana
the guru Me a fool seeing made chastisement

71 The Lord said, "Listen, Śrīpāda, to the reason for this. My guru saw that I was a fool, and he chastised Me:

Anubhāṣya.

Śrī Caitanya-deva is the Form of the real Reality, the one thing Vedānta establishes. Determining who is qualified to study Vedānta, He proclaimed that the right to the path of *śruti* belongs to those who are "humbler than a blade of grass," tolerant like a tree, who seek no honour for themselves and give honour to others.[10] The guru chants the words of *śruti* with his holy mouth, and the listener chants them after him; only this kīrtana — the *abhidheya*, that is, the *sādhana* — brings forth the fruit, the *prayojana*. That part of the words of *śruti* in which realised knowledge (*vijñāna*) of the real Reality, the object of worship, is glorified is the all-embracing whole (*aṁśī*), the root and source of the *śruti-śāstras*. Within that whole lie both the perception and the non-perception of all its parts. The devotee who serves the Reality that is worshipped is, by his own worship, connected with It. But where the inclination to serve grows slack, the Reality is grasped only in part instead of as the whole. As the inclination to serve slackens, the potency that rests on the worshipped Reality as its shelter becomes separated from It; this is forgetfulness of one's own true nature, or aversion to serving Hari.

Śrī Caitanya-deva, in teaching the devotee's pure conduct, independent of the world, showed the highest ideal of where Vedānta ultimately leads. And the best example of it is what the Lord of the fourteen worlds, free of all pride, says here: He speaks as a disciple. People intoxicated by the brilliance of their learning are not fit to serve the lotus feet of the guru — nor fit to study the *Brahma-sūtra*. The

nondevotee absorbed in a "second" (in something other than the Lord), while trying to serve the Reality that is worshipped, abandons service to the guru who himself worships It. To prevent any error in understanding the servant's own true nature in such a case, Bhagavān in the form of the guru, describing the pure nature of the disciple, speaks of his "foolishness." Śrī Gurudeva, for the disciple's good, says in simple words that the disciple lacks the qualification. In doing so he ascribes no relative fault to the disciple. The disciple's "foolishness" lies in not knowing the truth about Bhagavān. The modesty that befits a "fool" is eternally present in the disciple. We, however, not knowing our own true nature, often hypocritically pose as disciples and deceive those who are really our disciples by calling them "guru" with our lips; this brings us no good. All the Vedas constantly serve the feet of the Puruṣa who is known through Vedānta; one who judges Him by knowledge born of the senses is a "fool" indeed. Whatever a person bewildered by sensory knowledge takes to be the real foundation of the Vedic *śāstras* is guided by external intelligence and belongs to the lower knowledge (*aparā vidyā*). Until the jīva loses the conceit, born of the *guṇas*, that the world is subject to him, all his limited, undesirable, changing knowledge born of the senses is that same "foolishness."

One who is qualified for Vedānta is a servant of the Viṣṇu-*vastu* alone, the Great One and the Maintainer. Unless one goes beyond serving limited things and the like, one cannot become a knower of Brahman. Being qualified to read and teach the *Brahma-sūtra* on the level of karma or on the level of knowledge does not make one qualified for the name of Kṛṣṇa — the eternal, pure, complete, free Form of the rasa of consciousness, the transcendental *cintāmaṇi*. And one who is qualified for the name need not again acquire a qualification for Vedānta through knowledge born of the senses.

People who are not qualified to serve the name do not understand that the name and the One who bears the name are nondifferent, and they try to become Māyāvādī Vedāntists. By transcendental judgement they are, in the words of Śrī Gurudeva, the greatest "fools." Whoever studies Vedānta by relying on the ascending method (*adhiroha-vāda*) is overtaken by "foolishness," or dullness. But the one who is truly qualified for the name abides eternally on the far shore of Vedānta. In this connection one should reflect on the *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* verse "Oh, how great is even a dog-eater on the tip of whose tongue Your name abides! Those who chant Your name have already performed austerities and fire sacrifices, bathed at the holy places; they are true Āryans and have studied the Vedas,"[11] and others like

it, and also on the verse "One who has uttered the two syllables 'Ha-ri' has studied the *Ṛg-veda*, the *Yajur-veda*, the *Sāma-veda* and the *Atharva-veda*," and others.

The foolish sect of the *sāhajikas*, fancying themselves Vaiṣṇavas while being Vaiṣṇavas in name only, consider Vedānta the playground of the *ahaṅgrahopāsakas* — the *kevalādvaita-vādīs* who worship themselves as God. But "Vedānta" is the playground only of Hari's servants from Vaikuṇṭha. The Vaiṣṇava ācāryas of the four sampradāyas, following *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* — the commentary on the *Brahma-sūtra*, Vedānta — composed works on Vedānta, and these are not to be shunned as bad association. This simple point the *prākṛta-sahajiyās* cannot grasp. So they imagine the genuine pure Vaiṣṇavas and Vaiṣṇava ācāryas to be *viddha-bhaktas*, whose devotion is mixed with knowledge and karma; thus they head for hell and themselves become Māyāvādīs devoid of service to Viṣṇu. If one seeks the qualification for Vedānta through knowledge born of the senses, the meaning of chanting the Kṛṣṇa mantra cannot be realised. Those enchanted by sensory knowledge are bound in *saṁsāra* on every side. The two *tattvas* — the enjoyer and the enjoyed — have the power to hold them in *saṁsāra* and do not let them turn the mind away from external objects.

মূর্খ তুমি, তোমার নাহি বেদান্তাধিকার ।
'কৃষ্ণমন্ত্র' জপ' সদা, — এই মন্ত্রসার ॥ ৭২ ॥

mūrkha tumi, tomāra nāhi vedāntādhikāra
a fool You are Your there is not qualification for Vedānta
'kṛṣṇa-mantra' japa' sadā, — ei mantra-sāra
'the Kṛṣṇa-mantra' chant always this of mantras the essence

72 'You are a fool; You are not qualified for Vedānta. Always chant the Kṛṣṇa-mantra — it is the essence of all mantras.

The mantra and the mahā-mantra, the holy name: a variety of pastimes —

কৃষ্ণমন্ত্র হৈতে হবে সংসার-মোচন ।
কৃষ্ণনাম হৈতে পাবে কৃষ্ণের চরণ ॥ ৭৩ ॥

kṛṣṇa-mantra haite habe saṁsāra-mocana
the Kṛṣṇa-mantra from will be from saṁsāra release
kṛṣṇa-nāma haite pābe kṛṣṇera caraṇa
Kṛṣṇa's name from You will attain Kṛṣṇa's feet

73 From the Kṛṣṇa-mantra will come release from saṁsāra, and by Kṛṣṇa's name You will attain Kṛṣṇa's feet.

Anubhāṣya.

When the jīva attains divine knowledge (*divya-jñāna*), he is freed from absorption in the "second" and takes up the service of Adhokṣaja. Service to Mukunda is the only means (*upāya*) of ending one's endeavours in the external world, and it is also the goal (*upeya*). Chanting the mantra, the devotee gains transcendental experience step by step and ceases to perceive the external world as an object of enjoyment. Under the shelter of one of the five kinds of *rati*, when all the ingredients of rasa (*sāmagrī*) come together, by the power of serving rasa he tastes the One he worships in a heart made bright by *viśuddha-sattva*. Such practice is not mere enjoyment for the two *upādhis*. When the chanter of the name becomes truly established, in his very practice, in the divine knowledge that the name and the One who bears the name are nondifferent, he attains direct service to Kṛṣṇa. Then words in the dative case — the grammarians' language that defines relations — lose their hold on him. The real Reality addressed by the vocative word is at once captured in the heart made bright by *sattva*. And then he becomes able to serve Him without hindrance, addressing Him with vocative words. All the *śāstras* and all mantras consisting of divine knowledge free the jīva completely and engage him directly in the service of Kṛṣṇa.

All this I, a fool, have heard from Śrī Gurudeva. Śrī Vyāsa says: "For the sake of people who do not know [this], the learned sage compiled the *Sātvata-saṁhitā*."[12] *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* and similar books are the rungs of the ladder that leads to serving the name. Gurudeva taught that studying them, teaching them and discussing them all culminate in the service of the name. The name and the One who bears the name are one nondifferent Reality, knowable only to those free of the endeavours of māyā: this is the divine knowledge received at the guru's lotus feet. Until I took shelter at Śrī Guru's lotus feet I was a fool in my understanding of *sambandha*; but now that I have turned towards service, I see in myself the endeavours of one who knows what bondage and liberation are. The word "Kṛṣṇa's name" here does not mean *nāmābhāsa* or *nāmāparādha*.

In Kali-yuga the name of Kṛṣṇa alone is to be worshipped —

নাম বিনা কলিকালে নাহি আর ধর্ম্ম ।
সর্ব্বমন্ত্রসার নাম, — এই শাস্ত্রমর্ম্ম ॥ ৭৪ ॥

nāma vinā kali-kāle nāhi āra dharma
the name without in the age of Kali there is not other dharma
sarva-mantra-sāra nāma, — ei śāstra-marma
of all mantras the essence the name this of scripture the heart

74 In the age of Kali there is no dharma other than the name; the name is the essence of all mantras — this is the heart of the scriptures.'

Anubhāṣya.

In the three ages — Satya, Tretā and Dvāpara — the path of *śruti* was honoured; with the coming of Kali-yuga there arose a path alien to *śruti*, the path of argument. It is born when people doubt the descent of the real truth and when knowledge born of the senses prevails; this path opposes *śruti*. Kṛṣṇa's name is a Reality of Vaikuṇṭha, and so it is completely nondifferent from Kṛṣṇa, the real Reality. Because the name and the One who bears the name are nondifferent, the name of Vaikuṇṭha is just what Kṛṣṇa, the real Reality, is: the eternal, pure, complete, free Form of the rasa of consciousness and the transcendental *cintāmaṇi*. The name is distinct from the material names of everything other than Kṛṣṇa, and is Itself a Reality of Vaikuṇṭha. Followers of the path of argument have no access to this name. Only the worship of the name removes both *dharmas* of the *upādhis*, the gross and the subtle. That is why, in days when the path of argument prevails, all other limited (*kuṇṭha*) *dharmas* are hampered by it. Only the name Itself is the One who bears the name, the Reality beyond the arguments of the disputers. Only the name of the Reality of Vaikuṇṭha can deliver (*trāṇa*) the jīva from a mind (*manana*) intent on thoughts of material enjoyment, and therefore it is the essence of all mantras. The name, form, qualities, nature and actions of material things are subject to the path of argument; the Reality of Vaikuṇṭha is not. The transcendental name, form, qualities, distinctive associates and pastimes of this name of Vaikuṇṭha abide in nondual knowledge (*advaya-jñāna*). The Māyāvādīs, relying on knowledge born of the senses, posit a difference between the Reality's name, form and qualities, and so fall into the baseness of dualistic reasoning. That is why their teacher frees them from material reasoning with great sayings (*mahā-vākyas*) such as "In the beginning, my dear, there was Being alone"[13] and "All this is indeed

Brahman."[14] Without taking shelter of the holy name, while committing offences against the name, one never gets free from the path of argument, born of the senses and full of enjoyment.

The glory of the mantra is stated in the *Nārada-pañcarātra*: "The three Vedas, the six *vedāṅgas*, the meters, the many gods — all of these, and whatever else is expressed in words, are contained within the eight-syllable mantra. It is the essential meaning of all Vedānta and carries one across the ocean of *saṁsāra*." In the *Kali-santaraṇa Upaniṣad*: "'Hare Kṛṣṇa Hare Kṛṣṇa Kṛṣṇa Kṛṣṇa Hare Hare / Hare Rāma Hare Rāma Rāma Rāma Hare Hare' — these sixteen names destroy the contamination of Kali. No means higher than this is to be found in all the Vedas." The words that Śrī Madhva cites in his commentary on the *Muṇḍaka Upaniṣad*: "The people of Dvāpara worship Viṣṇu by the *Pañcarātra* alone, but in Kali the Lord Hari is worshipped by the name alone."

On the "Kṛṣṇa mantra" and the "name of Kṛṣṇa," Śrī Jīva Prabhu says in the *Bhakti-sandarbha* (section 284): "One may object: mantras consist of the names of Bhagavān; moreover, they are specially adorned with the word *namaḥ* and the like, Śrī Bhagavān and the venerable *ṛṣis* have invested them with special potencies, and they establish a special personal relationship [of the chanter] with Śrī Bhagavān. Yet the names of Śrī Bhagavān alone, depending on nothing else, are able to grant the fruit up to the highest goal of human life. That being so, since mantras do not gain greater power than the name, why is there need for *dīkṣā* and the like? The answer: intrinsically there is no such need. But people are mostly, by their very nature, through their connection with the body and so on, of base character and distracted mind. To curb this, the venerable *ṛṣis* and others have established certain rules here and there on the path of *arcana*."

You may say: mantras consist of the name of Bhagavān; what distinguishes a mantra is that, together with Bhagavān's name, it is adorned with the word *namaḥ* and the like — that is, it carries the mood of subordination to the name; by Bhagavān's will the *ṛṣis*, Śrī Nārada and others, invested the mantras with special potency; the mantras establish a special relationship between the one who utters the mantra and Śrī Bhagavān; and the names of Bhagavān contained in the mantra, depending on nothing else, are themselves able to grant the fruit up to the highest goal of human life. If so, then, since the mantra does not gain greater power than the name,[15] why does one who chants the name need *dīkṣā* into that mantra? To this Śrī Jīva replies: intrinsically, the one who chants the name has no need of

dīkṣā. But people mostly have a connection with a body and so on that is by nature bent on enjoyment; their character is base and their minds distracted. To curb that base nature and restlessness of mind, the *ṛṣis*, Śrī Nārada and others, have established certain rules in the mantra here and there on the path of *arcana*.

For the conditioned jīva to cease from enjoyment, that is, to be rid of the material ego, perfection in the mantra (*mantra-siddhi*) is necessary. In the word *namaḥ* the syllable "*ma*" means the ego and the syllable "*na*" its cessation; that is, the fruit of *mantra-siddhi* is the jīva's transcendental experience. And Śrī Rūpa Gosvāmī Prabhu in the *Nāmāṣṭaka* invokes the name of Hari with the words "O You, who are worshipped by hosts of the liberated!"[16]

The verse "harer nāma" —

এত বলি' এক শ্লোক শিখাইল মোরে ।
কণ্ঠে করি' এই শ্লোক করিহ বিচারে ॥ ৭৫ ॥

eta bali' eka śloka śikhāila more
thus saying one verse he taught Me
kaṇṭhe kari' ei śloka kariha vicāre
in the throat keeping this verse make reflection

75 Saying this, he taught Me a verse: 'Keep this verse on Your lips and reflect on it.'

(Bṛhan-nāradīya Purāṇa 38.126)

হরের্নাম হরের্নাম হরের্নামৈব কেবলম্ ।
কলৌ নাস্ত্যেব নাস্ত্যেব নাস্ত্যেব গতিরন্যথা ॥ ৭৬ ॥

harer nāma harer nāma
of Hari the name of Hari the name
harer nāmaiva kevalam
of Hari the name indeed only
kalau nāsty eva nāsty eva
in Kali there is not indeed there is not indeed
nāsty eva gatir anyathā
there is not indeed way other

76 “The name of Hari, the name of Hari, the name of Hari alone! In the age of Kali there is no other way, there is no other way, there is no other way.” (Bṛhan-nāradīya Purāṇa, 38.126)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

In Kali there is no way other than the name of Hari; the name of Hari is the only way.

Anubhāṣya.

(In Satya-yuga the way is meditation), **kalau nāsty eva** (only **harer nāma eva** [the name of Hari alone]); (in Tretā-yuga the way is worship of the Lord of sacrifice through *yajña*), **kalau nāsty eva** (only the name of Hari); (in Dvāpara-yuga the way is *arcana*), **kalau nāsty eva** (the way is only the name of Hari). (Especially) **kalau anyathā gatiḥ nāsty eva** (for all other *sādhanas* are fruitless).

The fruit of chanting the name —

এই আজ্ঞা পাঞা নাম লই অনুক্ষণ ।
নাম লৈতে লৈতে মোর ভ্রান্ত হৈল মন ॥ ৭৭ ॥

ei ājñā pāñā nāma lai anukṣaṇa
this order receiving the name I take constantly
nāma laite laite mora bhrānta haila mana
the name taking taking My bewildered became mind

77 Receiving this order, I took the name constantly, and as I chanted on and on, My mind grew bewildered.

ধৈর্য্য ধরিতে নারি, হৈলাম উন্মত্ত ।
হাসি, কান্দি, নাচি, গাই, যৈছে মদমত্ত ॥ ৭৮ ॥

dhairya dharite nāri, hailāma unmatta
composure to hold I cannot I became mad
hāsi, kāndi, nāci, gāi, yaiche madamatta
I laugh I weep I dance I sing like one intoxicated

78 I could no longer keep My composure; I became mad. I laughed and wept, I danced and sang like one intoxicated.

তবে ধৈর্য্য ধরি' মনে করিলাম বিচার ।
কৃষ্ণনামে জ্ঞানাচ্ছন্ন হইল আমার ॥ ৭৯ ॥

tabe dhairya dhari' mane karilāma vicāra
then composure holding in the mind I made consideration
kṛṣṇa-nāme jñānācchanna haila āmāra
by Kṛṣṇa's name knowledge-covered became My

79 Then, gathering My composure, I reflected: 'Kṛṣṇa's name has covered all My knowledge.

Amazement at seeing one's own state brought on by chanting the name —

পাগল হইলাঙ আমি, ধৈর্য্য নাহি মনে ।
এত চিন্তি' নিবেদিলাম গুরুর চরণে ॥ ৮০ ॥

pāgala hailāṅa āmi, dhairya nāhi mane
mad have become I composure there is not in the mind
eta cinti' nivedilāma gurura caraṇe
thus thinking I submitted at the guru's feet

80 I have gone mad; there is no composure left in My mind.' Thinking this, I came to the feet of My guru and said:

কিবা মন্ত্র দিলা, গোসাঞি, কিবা তার বল ।
জপিতে জপিতে মন্ত্র করিল পাগল ॥ ৮১ ॥

kibā mantra dilā, gosāñi, kibā tāra bala
what mantra you gave Gosāñi what its power
japite japite mantra karila pāgala
chanting chanting the mantra made mad

81 'What mantra have you given Me, Gosāñi? What power it has! Chanting it again and again, I have gone mad.

হাসায়, নাচায়, মোরে করায় ক্রন্দন ।
এত শুনি' গুরু মোরে বলিলা বচন ॥ ৮২ ॥

hāsāya, nācāya, more karāya krandana
it makes laugh makes dance Me makes weep
eta śuni' guru more balilā vacana
this hearing the guru to Me spoke words

82 It makes Me laugh, it makes Me dance, it makes Me weep.' Hearing this, My guru spoke these words to Me:

The nature of Kṛṣṇa's name —

কৃষ্ণনাম-মহামন্ত্রের এই ত' স্বভাব ।
যেই জপে, তার কৃষ্ণে উপজয়ে ভাব ॥ ৮৩ ॥

kṛṣṇa-nāma-mahā-mantrera ei ta' svabhāva
of the great mantra of Kṛṣṇa's name this indeed the nature
yei jape, tāra kṛṣṇe upajaye bhāva
whoever chants his for Kṛṣṇa arises bhāva

83 'Such is the nature of the great mantra, Kṛṣṇa's name: it awakens *bhāva* for Kṛṣṇa in whoever chants it.

Anubhāṣya.
When Śrī Gurudeva sings the name, that holy name enters the ears of the disciple. Following Śrī Gurudeva, the disciple places the holy name he has heard in his heart with faith and worships it by repeating it (*japa*). When the holy name is worshipped, He Himself unfolds His nature as the independent Agent and grants the chanter the right to kīrtana. It is then that, by singing the name, he becomes able to make the whole world his disciple. Under the instructing power of the name's kīrtana, the world begins to chant the name of Kṛṣṇa. As one goes on chanting, the way of serving the name becomes manifest in him — laughing, weeping, dancing, kīrtana and the rest. Some people, out of foolishness, do not know that the sixteen names "Hare Kṛṣṇa" — thirty-two syllables — are the *mahā-mantra*. Regarding it as merely a mantra for *japa*, they artificially obstruct the kīrtana of this *mahā-mantra*. Therefore one who has attained prema sings the name of Kṛṣṇa and, together with the devotees, performs the full kīrtana of Kṛṣṇa's name; through such kīrtana the people of the world receive instruction in Kṛṣṇa's name. Along with hearing and chanting the name comes remembrance of the name. Because the name and the One who bears the name are nondifferent, the power of chanting Kṛṣṇa's

name awakens the inclination to serve Kṛṣṇa, the Reality — and this is called "*bhāva*." Those in whom *bhāva* has been born are not bound by the fetters of *avidyā* and are free of *anarthas*. *Rati* has been born in them, and so they taste the rasa that arises when its four ingredients (*sāmagrī*) come together. *Bhāva* in its condensed state is "*prema*."

Kṛṣṇa's name is the *mahā-mantra*. The mantras of the *Pañcarātra* are known by the name "mantra," while the name of Bhagavān is renowned as the "*mahā-mantra*."

The four goals of life and love for Kṛṣṇa —

কৃষ্ণবিষয়ক প্রেমা — পরম পুরুষার্থ ।
যার আগে তৃণতুল্য চারি পুরুষার্থ ॥ ৮৪ ॥

kṛṣṇa-viṣayaka premā — parama puruṣārtha
for Kṛṣṇa prema the supreme goal of life
yāra āge tṛṇa-tulya cāri puruṣārtha
before which like straw the four goals of life

84 Prema for Kṛṣṇa is the supreme aim of human life; before it the four other goals are like straw.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

"*Dharma*," "*artha*," "*kāma*" and "*mokṣa*" are the four goals of human life (*puruṣārthas*). Love for Kṛṣṇa is the fifth goal. The bliss of Brahman and the like — the first stage of *mokṣa* — cannot be compared even with a single drop of it. *Dharma*, *artha*, *kāma* and *mokṣa* are not the "fruit" of Kṛṣṇa's name. All the *śāstras* agree that love for Kṛṣṇa is the one and only fruit of Kṛṣṇa's name.

Anubhāṣya.

Love for Kṛṣṇa is the highest of all the goals of the jīva. If one compares the fifth goal, prema, with the jīva's goals — dharma, *artha*, *kāma* and *mokṣa* — the gradation makes it clear that what those who hunger for enjoyment (*bubhukṣus*) and those who hunger for liberation (*mumukṣus*) attain is perishable and worthless. The hunger for enjoyment and the hunger for liberation are rooted in identifying oneself (*asmitā*) with the perishable *upādhis*. Love for Bhagavān is the eternal, unchanging dharma of the soul, and therefore all reasoning about the goals of the *catur-varga* — *bhukti* and *mukti* — is worth nothing compared with prema.

Prema, which puts mokṣa and the rest to shame, is the fifth goal of human life —

পঞ্চম পুরুষার্থ — প্রেমানন্দামৃতসিন্ধু ।
ব্রহ্মাদি আনন্দ যার নহে এক বিন্দু ॥ ৮৫ ॥

pañcama puruṣārtha — premānandāmṛta-sindhu
the fifth goal of life an ocean of the nectar of the bliss of prema
brahmādi ānanda yāra nahe eka bindu
of Brahman and the rest the bliss of which is not one drop

85 The fifth goal of life is prema, a boundless ocean of nectarean bliss; the bliss of Brahman and all the rest is not equal to a single drop of it.[3]

The fruit of Kṛṣṇa's name —

কৃষ্ণনামের ফল — 'প্রেমা', সর্ব্বশাস্ত্রে কয় ।
ভাগ্যে সেই প্রেমা তোমায় করিল উদয় ॥ ৮৬ ॥

kṛṣṇa-nāmera phala — 'premā', sarva-śāstre kaya
of Kṛṣṇa's name the fruit 'prema' in all scriptures it is said
bhāgye sei premā tomāya karila udaya
by good fortune that prema in You has made dawning

86 All the scriptures say that the fruit of Kṛṣṇa's name is prema, and by good fortune that prema has dawned in You.

The nature of love for Kṛṣṇa —

প্রেমার স্বভাবে করে চিত্ত-তনু ক্ষোভ ।
কৃষ্ণের চরণ-প্রাপ্ত্যে উপজায় লোভ ॥ ৮৭ ॥

premāra svabhāve kare citta-tanu kṣobha
by prema's nature it makes of mind and body agitation
kṛṣṇera caraṇa-prāptye upajāya lobha
of Kṛṣṇa's feet for the attainment arises greed

87 It is the nature of prema to stir both mind and body and to awaken a burning longing to attain Kṛṣṇa's feet.

প্রেমার স্বভাবে ভক্ত হাসে, কান্দে, গায় ।
উন্মত্ত হইয়া নাচে, ইতি-উতি ধায় ॥ ৮৮ ॥

premāra svabhāve bhakta hāse, kānde, gāya
by prema's nature the devotee laughs weeps sings
unmatta haiyā nāce, iti-uti dhāya
mad becoming dances here and there runs

88 Moved by prema, the devotee laughs, weeps and sings; as if mad, he dances and runs here and there.

Anubhāṣya.

Nondevotees devoid of love for Kṛṣṇa make a show of restless senses and, as if mad, laugh, weep, dance, sing and so on; but this is only a sign that misfortune awaits them. One engaged in *bhajana* must avoid in every way any artificial agitation of the body and senses. When the natural function of the soul awakens, *bhāva* and prema appear, and in them arise laughing, weeping, singing, dancing and longing (*utkaṇṭhā*). All of these are the genuine expressions of one who is turned towards service. But when a person in whom prema has not arisen audaciously claims the high position of a devotee, he brings calamity (*anartha*), that is, turmoil, into the world.

Śrī Jīva Prabhu says in the *Prīti-sandarbha* (section 66): "The function that is love for Bhagavān is not made of māyā or the like; it is the bliss of the *svarūpa-śakti*, on which even Śrī Bhagavān Himself depends." (Ibid., section 69):[17] "Thus the sign of *prīti* is the melting of the heart, and the signs of that are horripilation and the like. It has also been shown that if the melting of the heart, horripilation and the rest somehow arise but there is no purity of intention (*āśaya-śuddhi*), then even so bhakti has not fully appeared. Purity of intention means giving up every other aim and aiming at *prīti* alone. Hence its qualifiers: 'causeless' and 'natural.'"

The function that is love for Bhagavān is never made of māyā: it is the *svarūpa-śakti*, whose essence is bliss, for even Śrī Bhagavān is subject to that bliss. The sign of such *prīti* is the melting of the heart, and its result is horripilation and the like. But if, despite some melting of the heart or horripilation, there is no purity of intention, one must understand that bhakti has not fully appeared. "Purity of intention" means giving up other aims and aiming at *prīti* alone. Hence its qualifiers: "*ahaitukī*" (causeless) and "*svābhāvikī*" (natural).

The sāttvika and vyabhicārī bhāvas —

স্বেদ, কম্প, রোমাঞ্চাশ্রু, গদ্গদ, বৈবর্ণ্য ।
উন্মাদ, বিষাদ, ধৈর্য্য, গর্ব্ব, হর্ষ, দৈন্য ॥ ৮৯ ॥

এত ভাবে প্রেমা ভক্তগণেরে নাচায় ।
কৃষ্ণের আনন্দামৃতসাগরে ভাসায় ॥ ৯০ ॥

sveda, kampa, romāñcāśru, gadgada, vaivarṇya
perspiration trembling hair standing on end and tears faltering voice pallor
unmāda, viṣāda, dhairya, garva, harṣa, dainya
madness despondency steadiness pride joy humility
eta bhāve premā bhakta-gaṇere nācāya
with so many feelings prema the devotees makes dance
kṛṣṇera ānandāmṛta-sāgare bhāsāya
in Kṛṣṇa's ocean of the nectar of bliss makes float

89–90 Perspiration, trembling, hair standing on end, tears, a faltering voice and change of colour; madness, despondency, steadiness, pride, joy and humility — with all these feelings prema makes the devotees dance and sets them afloat on the ocean of the nectar of Kṛṣṇa's bliss.

The guru instructs the disciple in his duty —

ভাল হৈল, পাইলে তুমি পরমপুরুষার্থ ।
তোমার প্রেমেতে আমি হৈলাঙ কৃতার্থ ॥ ৯১ ॥

bhāla haila, pāile tumi parama-puruṣārtha
good it is You have attained You the supreme goal of life
tomāra premete āmi hailāṅa kṛtārtha
by Your prema I have become fulfilled

91 It is good that You have attained the supreme goal of life; by Your prema my own life has been fulfilled.

নাচ, গাও, ভক্তসঙ্গে কর সংকীর্ত্তন ।
কৃষ্ণনাম উপদেশি' তার' সর্ব্বজন ॥ ৯২ ॥

nāca, gāo, bhakta-saṅge kara saṅkīrtana
dance sing with the devotees perform saṅkīrtana
kṛṣṇa-nāma upadeśi' tāra' sarva-jana
Kṛṣṇa's name teaching deliver all people

92 Dance, sing and perform saṅkīrtana with the devotees; teach Kṛṣṇa's name and deliver all people.'

Anubhāṣya.
Those who have become qualified in the eyes of Śrī Gurudeva are granted by Śrī Gurudeva the right to dance, sing, perform saṅkīrtana and so on together with Hari's servants who are devoted to *bhajana*, like-minded and affectionate (*sajātīyāśaya-snigdha*). Only they, following in the footsteps of Śrī Gurudeva, take up the work of delivering the world with the knowledge of their own *bhajana*. Those who are not qualified should chant the name of Kṛṣṇa in solitude. In such worship there is no association with others. But once the qualification is attained, association with people can no longer bring an evil result; on the contrary, even people averse to the Lord then become able to receive the mercy of the name. In this connection one should reflect on such verses as "One who is not a controller should never do this, even in his mind"[18] or "When one is not attached to the objects of the senses, uses them as is fitting and firmly connects everything with Kṛṣṇa, that is called proper renunciation (*yukta-vairāgya*)."[19]

এত বলি' এক শ্লোক শিখাইল মোরে ।
ভাগবতের সার এই বলে বারে বারে ॥ ৯৩ ॥

eta bali' eka śloka śikhāila more
thus saying one verse he taught Me
bhāgavatera sāra ei bale vāre vāre
of the Bhāgavata the essence this he says again again

93 Saying this, he taught Me a verse and told Me again and again: 'This is the essence of the *Bhāgavata*.'

The state of a mahā-bhāgavata —

এবংব্রতঃ স্বপ্রিয়নামকীর্ত্ত্যা-
জাতানুরাগো দ্রুতচিত্ত উচ্চৈঃ ৷
হসত্যথো রোদিতি রৌতি গায়-
ত্যুন্মাদবন্নৃত্যতি লোকবাহ্যঃ ॥ ৯৪ ॥

evaṁ-vrataḥ sva-priya-nāma-kīrtyā
one with such a vow by the chanting of the names of his beloved
jātānurāgo druta-citta uccaiḥ
in whom love has arisen with melted heart loudly
hasaty atho roditi rauti gāyaty
laughs then weeps cries out sings
unmāda-van nṛtyati loka-bāhyaḥ
like a madman dances beyond the world

94 "One who has taken this vow, chanting the names of his beloved Lord, finds love awakening within him; his heart melts, and, heedless of the world, he laughs aloud, weeps, cries out, sings and dances like a madman." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 11.2.40)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

A person whose vow is service to Kṛṣṇa loses control of his heart: as he chants the name of his most beloved Śrī Kṛṣṇa, attachment (*anurāga*) awakens in him, and his heart melts. Like a madman he becomes *loka-bāhya*, that is, he no longer looks to anyone: now he laughs, now he weeps, now he cries out, now he sings, dances and does much else.

Anubhāṣya.

Vasudeva wished to hear from Śrī Nārada about *bhāgavata-dharma*. Śrī Nārada then told the story of the nine Yogendras, the sons of Ṛṣabha, and of Nimi, the king of Videha. In that story Kavi, one of the nine Yogendras, said to King Nimi:

evaṁ-vrataḥ (one whose vow is service in the form of hearing, chanting and so on) **sva-priya-nāma-kīrtyā** (by chanting and so on the name of his own dear Bhagavān) **jātānurāgaḥ** (one in whom attachment has been born — in whom *rati* has awakened; therefore) **druta-cittaḥ** (with a longing heart) **unmāda-vat loka-**

bāhyaḥ (outside people: unconcerned with their laughter, blame, praise and so on) **uccaiḥ hasati atho roditi**, **rauti** (cries out), **gāyati**, **nṛtyati ca**.

Firm endeavour in bhajana at the guru's command —

এই তাঁর বাক্যে আমি দৃঢ় বিশ্বাস ধরি' ।
নিরন্তর কৃষ্ণনাম সংকীর্ত্তন করি ॥ ৯৫ ॥

ei tāṁra vākye āmi dṛḍha viśvāsa dhari'
this his in the words I firm faith holding
nirantara kṛṣṇa-nāma saṅkīrtana kari
constantly Kṛṣṇa's name saṅkīrtana I do

95 With firm faith in these words of his, I constantly perform the saṅkīrtana of Kṛṣṇa's name.

The fruit of bhajana — the mercy of Śrī Nāma-Prabhu, who acts by His own will —

সেই কৃষ্ণনাম কভু গাওয়ায়, নাচায় ।
গাহি, নাচি নাহি আমি আপন-ইচ্ছায় ॥ ৯৬ ॥

sei kṛṣṇa-nāma kabhu gāoyāya, nācāya
that Kṛṣṇa's name at times makes sing makes dance
gāhi, nāci nāhi āmi āpana-icchāya
I sing I dance not I by My own will

96 That name of Kṛṣṇa sometimes makes Me sing and dance; I do not sing and dance of My own will.

Anubhāṣya.

Those who cannot believe the words of Śrī Gurudeva and pervert their own qualification (*adhikāra*) do not obtain the right to the saṅkīrtana of Kṛṣṇa's name. Śrī Gaurasundara upheld the words of the *śruti*: "To those great souls who have supreme devotion to God, and the same devotion to the guru, the whole meaning of what has been said is revealed"[20] — and He began the saṅkīrtana of Kṛṣṇa's name. Following His guru (*ānugatya*), He did not disobey his order and never stopped the unbroken *nāma-saṅkīrtana*. The kīrtana of such a Kṛṣṇa-nāma-Prabhu, by His own

power of will (*icchā-śakti*), moved Śrī Gaurasundara to dance and sing. Śrī Gaurasundara did not chant the holy name condescendingly, as if it were a material object. But those driven by the restlessness of the senses take Kṛṣṇa's name for their plaything: instead of serving the holy name, they try to become its masters and command it. Instead of *bhajana* they reap the fruits of karma — they merely aggravate their bile (*pitta*) and ruin their bodily health.

"I am a fool who cannot tell good from harm. I feared that if I went searching for the pure meaning of Vedānta, the false arguments of Māyāvāda spoken by Śrī Śaṅkarācārya would come and destroy My natural inclination to *bhajana*. So, knowing that I have no right to Vedānta as Śaṅkara explains it, I am freed from the *anarthas* of worldly existence simply by chanting the mantra of Kṛṣṇa. I take up the name of Kṛṣṇa, whom the liberated worship, and thereby attain Kṛṣṇa's lotus feet. In the quarrelsome age of Kali there is no dharma other than taking the name. I received all these instructions from Śrī Gurudeva, and by taking the name I became almost mad. Later I asked him again and learned that when the jīva attains the right to prema, an incomparable good comes to him. *Prema* is the highest goal of life (*parama-puruṣārtha*), desirable above all, and the petty hopes of those who crave the fruits of the four goals of life cannot be compared with it. A person in whom prema has awakened naturally disregards public shame and chants Kṛṣṇa's glories loudly — laughing, weeping, singing, dancing and so on. I learned that this is what is called 'the life of a *bhāgavata*.' I have done nothing artificially, hiding behind deceit. I chant Kṛṣṇa's glories because I firmly believe My Gurudeva's words. The holy name Himself has made Me a singer and a dancer, in defiance of the grave dignity of the *kaupīna*-clad Vedāntists. My own part in this — My own will or initiative — is very small: it is all the mercy of Śrī Nāma-Prabhu."

The difference between the bliss of Brahman and the bliss of love for Kṛṣṇa —

কৃষ্ণনামে যে আনন্দসিন্ধু-আস্বাদন ।
ব্রহ্মানন্দ তার আগে খাতোদক-সম ॥ ৯৭ ॥

kṛṣṇa-nāme ye ānanda-sindhu-āsvādana
in Kṛṣṇa's name which of the ocean of bliss the tasting
brahmānanda tāra āge khātodaka-sama
the bliss of Brahman of that before like water in a ditch

97 Before the ocean of bliss tasted in Kṛṣṇa's name, the bliss of Brahman is like water in a ditch.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Khātodaka: a little water in a ditch.

Anubhāṣya.
See Ādi 6.43–44.

A comparison of the ocean and a cow's hoofprint —

ত্বৎসাক্ষাৎকরণাহ্লাদ-বিশুদ্ধাব্ধিস্থিতস্য মে ।
সুখানি গোষ্পদায়ন্তে ব্রাহ্মাণ্যপি জগদ্গুরো ॥ ৯৮ ॥

tvat-sākṣāt-karaṇāhlāda-
from seeing You face to face the joy
viśuddhābdhi-sthitasya me
in the pure ocean situated for me
sukhāni goṣ-padāyante
joys become like a calf's hoofprint
brāhmāṇy api jagad-guro
of Brahman even O Guru of the world

98 "O Guru of the world, now that I am immersed in the pure ocean of joy that comes from seeing You face to face, all other joys — even the bliss of Brahman — seem to me like the water in a calf's hoofprint." (Hari-bhakti-sudhodaya, 14.36)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
O Teacher of the world! I have seen You Yourself (Your *svarūpa*), and now I abide in a pure ocean of joy. All other happiness seems to me like a cow's hoofprint; even the happiness the jīva finds in dissolving into Brahman is only a hoofprint. Where a cow steps, a hollow is left; the water in it is tiny compared with the ocean.

Anubhāṣya.
he jagad-guro (O Teacher of the world) **tvat-sākṣāt-karaṇāhlāda-viśuddhābdhi-sthitasya** (abiding in the pure — that is, unmixed — ocean of the joy born from directly seeing You, from Your *darśana*) **me** (my) **brāhmāṇi** (born of realising

Brahman) **sukhāni api goṣ-padāyante** (seem like the water in the hollow of a cow's hoofprint).

The gradual change in the minds of the sannyāsīs, and their question —

প্রভুর মিষ্টবাক্য শুনি' সন্ন্যাসীর গণ ।
চিত্ত ফিরি' গেল, কহে মধুর বচন ॥ ৯৯ ॥

prabhura miṣṭa-vākya śuni' sannyāsīra gaṇa
the Lord's sweet words hearing of the sannyāsīs the company
citta phiri' gela, kahe madhura vacana
their hearts turning went they speak sweet words

99 Hearing the Lord's sweet words, the sannyāsīs had a change of heart, and they answered Him with gentle words:

Still, their faith in bhakti is slight, but their faith in Māyāvāda is firm —

যে কিছু কহিলে তুমি, সর্ব্ব সত্য হয় ।
কৃষ্ণপ্রেমা সেই পায়, যার ভাগ্যোদয় ॥ ১০০ ॥

ye kichu kahile tumi, sarva satya haya
whatever You have said You all true is
kṛṣṇa-premā sei pāya, yāra bhāgyodaya
love for Kṛṣṇa he attains whose fortune has dawned

100 "All that You have said is true: love for Kṛṣṇa is attained only by one whose good fortune has dawned.

কৃষ্ণে ভক্তি কর — ইহায় সবার সন্তোষ ।
বেদান্ত না শুন কেনে, তার কিবা দোষ ॥ ১০১ ॥

kṛṣṇe bhakti kara — ihāya sabāra santoṣa
to Kṛṣṇa devotion You practise in this of all the satisfaction
vedānta nā śuna kene, tāra kibā doṣa
Vedānta not You hear why its what fault

101 You have devotion for Kṛṣṇa, and we are all pleased with that. But why do You not hear Vedānta? What fault is there in it?"

Anubhāṣya.

The Māyāvādīs call "Vedānta" only the scripture that Śrī Śaṅkarapāda's *Śārīraka-bhāṣya* has in view. In other words, when the followers of Śaṅkara's doctrine say "Vedānta," they mean the Upaniṣads and the *Brahma-sūtra* as read through their ācārya's commentary, which is built on the doctrine of *kevalādvaita*. The *Vedānta-sāra* of Sadānanda Yogīndra says: "Vedānta is the evidence of the Upaniṣads, together with the *Śārīraka-sūtras* and other works that assist it." In truth, however, the word "Vedānta" does not mean the doctrine of *kevalādvaita*. All four Vaiṣṇava ācāryas are ācāryas of Vedānta, yet they are not Māyāvādīs and do not follow Śaṅkara's doctrine. The followers of Māyāvāda see no difference at all; starting from *kevalādvaita*, they worship themselves as God (*ahaṅgrahopāsanā*). They accept neither *śuddhādvaita*, nor *śuddha-dvaita*, nor *viśiṣṭādvaita*, nor *dvaitādvaita*, nor *acintya-bhedābheda*; they believe that *kevalādvaita* alone is the faultless doctrine of Vedānta. The Māyāvādīs are pleased with the impermanent service that is rendered to Kṛṣṇa with a material body and mind. That is, they regard devotion to Kṛṣṇa as merely a special kind of ritual work (*karma*); so for them it too is "non-devotion" (*abhakti*), and with this they are content.

The Lord's words —

এত শুনি' হাসি' প্রভু বলিলা বচন ।
দুঃখ না মানিহ যদি, করি নিবেদন ॥ ১০২ ॥

eta śuni' hāsi' prabhu balilā vacana
this hearing smiling the Lord spoke words
duḥkha nā māniha yadi, kari nivedana
offence not you take if I make submission

102 Hearing this, the Lord smiled and said, "If you will not take offence, I shall explain."

The humility of the Māyāvādī sannyāsīs —

ইহা শুনি' বলে সর্ব্ব সন্ন্যাসীর গণ ।
তোমাকে দেখিয়ে যৈছে সাক্ষাৎ নারায়ণ ॥ ১০৩ ॥

ihā śuni' bale sarva sannyāsīra gaṇa
this hearing say all of the sannyāsīs the company
tomāke dekhiye yaiche sākṣāt nārāyaṇa
You we see as directly Nārāyaṇa

103 At this all the sannyāsīs said, "We see You as Nārāyaṇa Himself.

তোমার বচন শুনি' জুড়ায় শ্রবণ ।
তোমার মাধুরী দেখি' জুড়ায় নয়ন ॥ ১০৪ ॥

tomāra vacana śuni' juḍāya śravaṇa
Your words hearing are soothed the ears
tomāra mādhurī dekhi' juḍāya nayana
Your sweetness seeing are soothed the eyes

104 Your words soothe our ears, and the sight of Your sweetness soothes our eyes.

তোমার প্রভাবে সবার আনন্দিত মন ।
কভু অসঙ্গত নহে তোমার বচন ॥ ১০৫ ॥

tomāra prabhāve sabāra ānandita mana
by Your influence of all joyful the minds
kabhu asaṅgata nahe tomāra vacana
ever unfitting not are Your words

105 Your presence has filled all our hearts with joy, and Your words are never unfitting."

The Lord's view and explanation of Vedānta —

প্রভু কহে, বেদান্ত-সূত্র — ঈশ্বর-বচন ।
ব্যাসরূপে কৈল তাহা শ্রীনারায়ণ ॥ ১০৬ ॥

prabhu kahe, vedānta-sūtra — īśvara-vacana
the Lord says the Vedānta-sūtra of Īśvara the words
vyāsa-rūpe kaila tāhā śrī-nārāyaṇa
in the form of Vyāsa composed it Śrī Nārāyaṇa

106 The Lord said, "The *Vedānta-sūtra* is the word of the Lord: Śrī Nārāyaṇa Himself composed it in the form of Vyāsa.[4]

Anubhāṣya.

Sūtra: "Knowers of sūtras know a sūtra to be brief, unambiguous, full of essence, facing every side, free of superfluous words, and faultless." (*Skanda Purāṇa* and *Vāyu Purāṇa*) The *Vedānta-sūtra* is known by various names: (1) *Brahma-sūtra*, (2) *Śārīraka*, (3) *Vyāsa-sūtra*, (4) *Bādarāyaṇa-sūtra*, (5) *Uttara-mīmāṁsā* and (6) *Vedānta-darśana*. It is a book composed of sūtras, with four chapters (*adhyāyas*) and sixteen quarters (*pādas*). Each *pāda* contains several topics (*adhikaraṇas*). Each topic contains the five-membered argument (*pañcāvayava-nyāya*): the proposition (*pratijñā*), the reason (*hetu*), the example (*udāharaṇa*), the application (*upanaya*) and the conclusion (*nigamana*). In other words: "One verse [states] the subject and the doubt and sets out the *pūrvapakṣa*; the other verse establishes the *siddhānta*; the connections between them are clear."

According to the different commentaries, it has from 162 to 223 topics (*adhikaraṇas*) and from 520 to 560 sūtras.

On the word "Vedānta" the lexicographer Hemacandra says: "Vedānta is the Upaniṣads together with the Brāhmaṇas — the remainder of the Vedas, their last portion, that is, the end of the Vedas." A scripture that shows the ultimate purpose of the Vedas is also "Vedānta." A scripture that uses the Upaniṣads as its evidence, and the sūtras and other works that assist it, are also "Vedānta." The *Vedānta-sūtra* is called the *nyāya-prasthāna*, one of the three *prasthānas* (foundations of doctrine). The Upaniṣads are the *śruti-prasthāna*, and the *Gītā*, the *Mahābhārata*, the Purāṇas and so on are the *smṛti-prasthāna*.

The Vedas came into the material world from the breath of Śrī Nārāyaṇa. The scripture spoken by Śrī Nārāyaṇa that unfolds the Vedas is called the *Sātvata-*

pañcarātra. The *Vedānta-sūtra* was compiled by Śrī Vyāsa, the *āveśa-avatāra* of Śrī Nārāyaṇa — or, in the opinion of some (Śaṅkara's commentary 3.3.32),[21] by the sage Apāntaratamā. Śrī Gaurasundara says that the *Pañcarātra* and the Vedānta express one and the same teaching. Since Śrī Vyāsa composed the sūtras, they too must be known as the word of Śrī Nārāyaṇa Himself.

While composing the sūtras, Śrī Vyāsadeva examined the Vedānta doctrines set forth by seven other sages: Ātreya, Āśmarathya, Auḍulomi, Kārṣṇājini, Kāśakṛtsna, Jaimini and Bādari. Besides these, two more collections — the sūtras of Pārāśarī and of Karmandī-bhikṣu — also preceded the sūtras of Śrī Vyāsa.

The first two chapters of the *Vedānta-darśana* describe knowledge of *sambandha*; the third chapter, *abhidheya*, the practice of devotion (*sādhana-bhakti*); and the fourth, *prayojana*, the fruit: love for Bhagavān. The genuine commentary on Vedānta, written by Vyāsa, the author of the sūtras himself, is the *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam*. Besides it, the commentaries of the four Vaiṣṇava ācāryas, who follow the *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* to a greater or lesser degree, and the many glosses written by their successors in their sampradāyas, declare that Vedānta aims at the worship of Bhagavān. This *Vedānta-sūtra* is honoured even in the sampradāya that lacks devotion to Viṣṇu and holds to the doctrine of the featureless. The commentaries on this Vedānta written from the standpoint of māyā, and the glosses, treatises and other works that follow them, are devoid of service to Viṣṇu, and their reasoning departs from the real truth.

(1) The word of the Lord is free from the four defects —

ভ্রম, প্রমাদ, বিপ্রলিপ্সা, করণাপাটব ।
ঈশ্বরের বাক্যে নাহি দোষ এই সব ॥ ১০৭ ॥

bhrama, pramāda, vipralipsā, karaṇāpāṭava
error inattention the wish to deceive imperfection of the senses
īśvarera vākye nāhi doṣa ei saba
of Īśvara in the words there are not faults these all

107 Error, inattention, the wish to deceive and the imperfection of the senses — none of these faults is found in the words of the Lord.

Anubhāṣya.
See Ādi 2.86.

(2) By the direct (primary) meaning (abhidhā-vṛtti), what Vedānta makes known is Bhagavān, the Truth possessed of features —

উপনিষৎ-সহিত সূত্র কহে যেই তত্ত্ব ।
মুখ্যবৃত্ত্যে সেই অর্থ পরম মহত্ত্ব ॥ ১০৮ ॥

upaniṣat-sahita sūtra kahe yei tattva
the Upaniṣads together with the sūtras speak which truth
mukhya-vṛttye sei artha parama mahattva
by the primary sense that meaning of supreme greatness

108 The truth that the sūtras declare together with the Upaniṣads is of supreme greatness when taken in its primary sense.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

The Upaniṣads are the Īśa, Kena, Kaṭha, Praśna, Muṇḍaka, Māṇḍūkya, Taittirīya, Aitareya, Chāndogya, Bṛhad-āraṇyaka and Śvetāśvatara: eleven Upaniṣads, the crown of the Vedas.

The sūtra is the *Brahma-sūtra*: four chapters, sixteen *pādas*. These two are the chief among the scriptures.

Śaṅkara's commentary was written in the secondary meaning to bewilder the asuras; to hear it is to lose everything —

গৌণ-বৃত্ত্যে যেবা ভাষ্য করিল আচার্য্য ।
তাহার শ্রবণে নাশ যায় সর্ব্ব কার্য্য ॥ ১০৯ ॥

gauṇa-vṛttye yebā bhāṣya karila ācārya
by the secondary sense the commentary made the Ācārya
tāhāra śravaṇe nāśa yāya sarva kārya
its by hearing ruin goes all work

109 But to hear the commentary that the Ācārya wrote in the secondary sense is to lose every spiritual gain.

Anubhāṣya.

The *Muktikā Upaniṣad* (30–39)[22] lists: "Īśa, Kena, Kaṭha, Praśna, Muṇḍa, Māṇḍūkya, Tittiri, Aitareya, Chāndogya and Bṛhad-āraṇyaka; Brahma, Kaivalya,

Jābāla, Śvetāśva, Haṁsa, Āruṇi, Garbha, Nārāyaṇa, Haṁsa, Bindu, Nāda, Śiraḥ, Śikhā; Maitrāyaṇī, Kauṣītakī, Bṛhaj-jābāla, Tāpanī, Kālāgni-rudra, Maitreyī, Subāla, Kṣuri, Mantrikā; Sarvasāra, Nirālamba, Rahasya, Vajrasūcikā; Tejo, Nāda, Dhyāna, Vidyā, Yoga-tattva, Ātma-bodha; Parivrāṭ, Triśikhī, Sītā, Cūḍā, Nirvāṇa, Maṇḍala; Dakṣiṇā, Śarabha, Skanda, the one called Mahānārāyaṇa; Rahasya, Rāma-tapana, Vāsudeva and Mudgala; Śāṇḍilya, Paiṅgala, Bhikṣu, Mahat, Śārīraka, Śikhā; Turīyātīta, Sannyāsa, Parivrāja, Akṣamālikā; Avyakta, Ekākṣara, Pūrṇā, Sūrya, Akṣi, Adhyātma, Kuṇḍikā; Sāvitrī, Ātmā, Pāśupata, Parabrahma, Avadhūta; Tripurā-tapana, Devī, Tripurā, Kaṭha, Bhāvanā; Hṛdaya, Kuṇḍalī, Bhasma, Rudrākṣa, Gaṇa, Darśana; Tāra-sāra, Mahā-vākya, Pañca-brahma, Agnihotra; Gopāla-tapana, Kṛṣṇa, Yājñavalkya, Varāha; Śāṭyāyanī, Hayagrīva, Dattātreya and Gāruḍa; Kali, Jābāli, Saubhāgya, Rahasya and Muktikā." These are the one hundred and eight Upaniṣads.

The word *mukhya-vṛtti* means *abhidhā-vṛtti*. *Abhidhā* is the power [of a word] by which one understands the meaning known from dictionaries, grammar and so on. The word *gauṇa-vṛtti* means *lakṣaṇā-vṛtti*. *Lakṣaṇā* is the power by which, for some purpose or through frequent usage, one understands another meaning connected with the actual sense.

Bhāṣya — as it is said: "Knowers of *bhāṣya* know that a *bhāṣya* takes up the words of the sūtra, explains them in sentences that follow the sūtra, and also explains its own words."

The highest is the Truth possessed of features (*saviśeṣa-tattva*): it is what the Upaniṣads and the sūtras establish, and it is shown through the direct (*abhidhā*) meaning. The *nirviśeṣa-vādīs*, however, rely on the secondary (*lakṣaṇā*) meaning and show only a semblance of truth (*tattvābhāsa*); it is known not as "Tattvavāda" but as "Māyāvāda." Śrī Viṣṇusvāmī's *śuddhādvaita* was obstructed by the doctrine of *kevalādvaita*. Only after this did *viśiṣṭādvaita* and the "Tattvavāda" of Śrī Madhvācārya, following the path of the *śruti*, refute the conclusions of those ignorant of the truth, which rested on logic alone. Śrī Mahāprabhu relied on *abhidhā-vṛtti* and honoured the meaning of Vedānta. But the meaning of Vedānta that Śrī Śaṅkarācārya set down in his commentary, relying on *lakṣaṇā-vṛtti*, ruins everything. Thus in the *Padma Purāṇa*: "Hear, O Devī, I shall tell you in order of the *tāmasa* [scriptures], by merely hearing which even the learned fall. [In Māyāvāda] the words of the *śruti* are given a false meaning, which people condemn; in it, it is taught that action must be given up by its very nature. There, freedom from action

(*naiṣkarmya*) is said to be the abandonment of all action. And in it I establish the oneness of the Supreme Soul and the jīva."

See Antya 2.94–99.

তাঁহার নাহিক দোষ, ঈশ্বর-আজ্ঞা পাঞা ।
গৌণার্থ করিল মুখ্য অর্থ আচ্ছাদিয়া ॥ ১১০ ॥

tāṁhāra nāhika doṣa, īśvara-ājñā pāñā
his there is not fault of Īśvara the order receiving
gauṇārtha karila mukhya artha ācchādiyā
the secondary meaning he made the primary meaning covering

110 The fault is not his: he received the Lord's order and so gave the secondary meaning, covering the primary.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

The truth that these chief scriptures teach by their primary meaning (*mukhya-vṛtti*), that is, by *abhidhā-vṛtti*, is supremely great. Śrī Śaṅkarācārya abandoned the primary meaning of these scriptures, established the conclusion of *kevalādvaita* by their secondary meaning (*gauṇa-vṛtti*), that is, by *lakṣaṇā-vṛtti*, and wrote his commentary. Whoever hears it loses every spiritual endeavour. You may ask: why did Śaṅkara Svāmī, a direct avatāra of Śiva, do such an improper thing? Then listen: he undertook this work at the Lord's command, and so he bears no fault. Thus in the *Padma Purāṇa* Śrī Mahādeva says: "Māyāvāda is a false doctrine; it is called covert Buddhism. O Devī, in the age of Kali I Myself devised it in the form of a brāhmaṇa. To bewilder all the people of this world in the age of Kali, I shall describe Brahman in another form — as devoid of qualities (*nirguṇa*). O Devī, in the great scripture, the Vedānta, I Myself shall expound the non-Vedic Māyāvāda, to bring the world to ruin." And in the *Śiva Purāṇa* Bhagavān says: "At the beginning of Dvāpara and the other ages, appear by your partial power among humans and others, and by *āgamas* of your own invention turn people away from Me."

(3) The śrutis establish Bhagavān alone, full of spiritual pastimes and opulence

—

‘ব্রহ্ম’-শব্দে মুখ্য অর্থে কহে — ‘ভগবান্’ ।
চিদৈশ্বর্য্য-পরিপূর্ণ, অনূর্দ্ধ-সমান ॥ ১১১ ॥

‘brahma’-śabde mukhya arthe kahe — ‘bhagavān’
‘Brahman’-in the word in the primary sense says ‘Bhagavān’
cid-aiśvarya-paripūrṇa, anūrdhva-samāna
with spiritual majesty full having none above or equal

111 In its primary sense the word “Brahman” means Bhagavān, full of spiritual majesty, with none above Him or equal to Him.

(4) He possesses a form full of eternal being, knowledge and bliss, and is not formless —

তাঁহার বিভূতি, দেহ, — সব চিদাকার ।
চিদ্বিভূতি আচ্ছাদিয়া কহে ‘নিরাকার’ ॥ ১১২ ॥

tāṁhāra vibhūti, deha, — saba cid-ākāra
His opulence body all of spiritual form
cid-vibhūti ācchādiyā kahe ‘nirākāra’
the spiritual opulence covering he calls ‘formless’

112 His opulence and His body are all spiritual in form; but, covering His spiritual opulence, the Ācārya calls Him “formless”.

To call the Truth formless, and the body of Viṣṇu and so on a transformation of māyā — this is “Māyāvāda” —

চিদানন্দ — দেহ, তাঁর স্থান, পরিবার ।
তাঁরে কহে — প্রাকৃত-সত্ত্বের বিকার ॥ ১১৩ ॥

cid-ānanda — deha, tāṁra sthāna, parivāra
spiritual bliss His body His abode retinue
tāṁre kahe — prākṛta-sattvera vikāra
Him they call of material sattva a transformation

113 His body, His abode and His retinue are spiritual bliss, yet they say that He is a transformation of material *sattva*.

Anubhāṣya.

The *Vedānta-sāra* of Sadānanda Yogīndra says: "The real (*vastu*) is Brahman — being, consciousness and bliss, nondual. The whole mass of inert things, beginning with ignorance (*ajñāna*), is the unreal (*avastu*). Ignorance, they say, cannot be described as either existent or nonexistent; it consists of the three *guṇas*, is opposed to knowledge, is of a positive nature, and is 'something.' This ignorance is spoken of as one or as many, depending on whether one means the aggregate or the individual. This aggregate, because its *upādhi* is excellent, is one in which pure *sattva* predominates. Consciousness conditioned by it, possessing qualities such as omniscience, lordship over all and control over all, is *sad-asad-avyakta*, unmanifest as either the existent or the nonexistent; it is the inner ruler, the cause of the world, and it is called Īśvara. Because it illumines all ignorance, it is omniscient."

The Śaṅkarite Vedāntist Sadānanda summarised the purport of Śaṅkara's doctrine in the book *Vedānta-sāra*. Today this book is a highly respected, authoritative foundation of Śaṅkara's sampradāya.

"Brahman is the nondual Reality, being, consciousness and bliss; the whole mass of inert things, beginning with ignorance, is unreal. 'Ignorance' means everything that is distinct from both the existent and the nonexistent, indescribable, made of the three *guṇas*, opposed to knowledge and of a positive nature. This ignorance is spoken of both as one and as many, depending on whether it is the aggregate or the individual. When this aggregate is endowed with an excellent *upādhi*, it receives the name 'that in which pure *sattva* predominates.' When this [aggregate ignorance], in which pure *sattva* predominates, is reflected in consciousness, [consciousness] receives the name 'Īśvara' — omniscient, lord of all, ruler of all, unmanifest as either the existent or the nonexistent (*sad-asad-avyakta*), the inner ruler of the jīvas, the cause of the world. Īśvara is 'omniscient' because He illumines all ignorance. In their view, being Īśvara is merely a transformation of material *sattva* born of ignorance. The jīva, in turn, is one in whom impure *sattva* predominates, and he is endowed with an individual *upādhi*."

Anubhāṣya.

See Madhya 25.33–34.

Though Śaṅkara, who carried out the order, is not at fault, the jīva who hears his commentary loses everything —

তাঁর দোষ নাহি, তেঁহো আজ্ঞাকারী দাস ।
আর যেই শুনে, তার হয় সর্ব্বনাশ ॥ ১১৪ ॥

tāṁra doṣa nāhi, teṁho ājñā-kārī dāsa
his fault there is not he order-carrying servant
āra yei śune, tāra haya sarva-nāśa
but whoever hears his is utter ruin

114 The fault is not his, for he is a servant who carries out orders; but whoever listens to him meets with utter ruin.

Anubhāṣya.
See Madhya 6.169.

To regard Viṣṇu, the Master of māyā, as a product of māyā — this is godlessness (pāṣaṇḍatā) —

প্রাকৃত করিয়া মানে বিষ্ণু-কলেবর ।
বিষ্ণুনিন্দা আর নাহি ইহার উপর ॥ ১১৫ ॥

prākṛta kariyā māne viṣṇu-kalevara
material taking he regards Viṣṇu's body
viṣṇu-nindā āra nāhi ihāra upara
Viṣṇu-blasphemy other there is not this above

115 One who regards the body of Viṣṇu as material commits the gravest blasphemy against Viṣṇu; there is none greater than this.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
The meaning that appears clearly, that is, directly, as soon as one reads a text is called the primary meaning (*mukhyārtha*). The *Bṛhad-āraṇyaka* says: "That is full, this is full; from the full the full comes forth" (5.1). The *Śvetāśvatara* says: "The ancient Puruṣa, possessed of wondrous potencies"; "He is beyond the tree [of worldly existence], time and forms, and other than them; from Him this world revolves; He brings dharma, removes sin, and is the Lord of all opulence" (6.6); "I know this great Puruṣa, radiant like the sun, beyond darkness" (3.8); "the supreme

Master of masters, higher than the highest" (6.7); "the Puruṣa is the great Lord" (3.12); "His supreme potency is heard to be manifold" (6.8), and so on. The *Ṛg-veda* says: "The sages always see that supreme abode of Viṣṇu." The *Praśna* says: "He glanced" (6.3). The *Aitareya* says: "He glanced" (1.1.1) and "He created these worlds" (1.1.2). The *Talavakāra* says: "Brahman knew [their pride] and appeared before them" (3.2). As soon as one reads many such statements of the Vedas, it becomes clear that [they speak] only of Bhagavān, the one Supreme Truth, full of the six opulences, who has none equal to Him or above Him. There are, of course, statements that deny form, such as *apāṇi-pādaḥ* ("without hands and feet") (*Śvetāśvatara* 3.19). They must be understood only to mean that this Bhagavān's form is spiritual, and that His body and His opulence are spiritual opulence. The Māyāvādīs, headed by the ācārya, cover His spiritual opulence and declare Him "formless," a transformation of the quality of *sattva*. But He Himself, His abode and His associates are all, by nature, spiritual bliss beyond *prakṛti*. How, then, can He be called a transformation of material *sattva*? In truth His form too, full of transcendental spiritual opulence, is real. Is the ācārya at fault for describing Him as formless? No — he is a servant carrying out an order. As the *Nārada-pañcarātra* says: "And conceal Me, so that this creation may keep on increasing." But anyone else who hears such an explanation loses everything. There can be no worse blasphemy of Viṣṇu than to consider Viṣṇu's body "material."

Anubhāṣya.

The Truth possessed of features is Viṣṇu. Viṣṇu's *prakṛti* is the root of the material, inert world. In the reasoning of *vivarta-vāda*, the *prakṛti*, or *māyā-śakti*, of the featureless Brahman has no real existence. The scriptures have described Viṣṇu's māyā at length. Viṣṇu is not some god born of māyā. Those who think so have a distorted idea of Viṣṇu. Viṣṇu can never be counted among the material gods. Only those deluded in this way regard Viṣṇu as a material deity. To free them from the bondage of worldly existence, Śrī Bhagavān said in the *Gītā*:

"This divine māyā of Mine, made of the *guṇas*, is hard to overcome. But those who surrender to Me cross over this māyā."[23] Viṣṇu is the Reality of Vaikuṇṭha. To regard Him as a deity born of *prakṛti* is to do violence to what is said about the Reality; this is blasphemy. Viṣṇu is the Reality beyond the senses (*adhokṣaja*): He cannot be perceived by the material senses, as material objects are. Between His body and the possessor of that body there is nonduality (*advaya-jñāna*). In material things, the body and its possessor are different. Material things are objects of enjoyment, but Viṣṇu is eternally the enjoyer. To regard the "enjoyer" as the "en-

joyed" is an offence. And to present the One whom the jīva eternally serves as a servant on a level with the jīva is to blaspheme Him.

See the *Anubhāṣya* on Ādi 7.112–113 and Madhya 25.35–39.

ঈশ্বরের তত্ত্ব — যেন জ্বলিত জ্বলন ।
জীবের স্বরূপ যৈছে স্ফুলিঙ্গের কণ ॥ ১১৬ ॥

īśvarera tattva — yena jvalita jvalana
of Īśvara the truth like blazing fire
jīvera svarūpa yaiche sphuliṅgera kaṇa
of the jīva the nature like of a spark a particle

116 The truth of the Lord is like a blazing fire, and the jīva in its true nature is like a particle of a spark.

জীবতত্ত্ব — শক্তি, কৃষ্ণতত্ত্ব — শক্তিমান্ ।
গীতা-বিষ্ণুপুরাণাদি তাহাতে প্রমাণ ॥ ১১৭ ॥

jīva-tattva — śakti, kṛṣṇa-tattva — śaktimān
the jīva-truth potency the Kṛṣṇa-truth the possessor of potency
gītā-viṣṇupurāṇādi tāhāte pramāṇa
Gītā Viṣṇu Purāṇa and others in that the evidence

117 The jīva is a potency (*śakti*); Kṛṣṇa is the possessor of all potency (*śaktimān*). The *Gītā*, the *Viṣṇu Purāṇa* and other scriptures bear witness to this.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

If the truth of the Lord is compared to a blazing fire, the countless jīvas can be compared to tiny sparks of that fire. The point is this: the Lord is a special fire — spiritual, unlimited and blazing. The countless jīvas have come forth from Him like tiny sparks and become separate *tattvas*. Here māyā plays no part in forming the jīva's *svarūpa*; that is, nothing material takes place. You may ask: why form such particles of spirit at all? Then listen: the Lord's wondrous *svarūpa-śakti* has two kinds of tendencies — towards unlimited action and towards minute action. From the tendency towards unlimited action come the Lord's own form and the Vaikuṇṭha-*tattva*, the spiritual world; this tendency is called *cit-śakti*. From the ten-

dency towards minute action come the countless jīvas, atomic consciousness; this tendency is called *jīva-śakti*. If the *svarūpa-śakti* did not have both these functions, His fullness would be impaired. Bhagavān is full of all opulence, and so the jīva — the minute action of His potency — must exist inevitably and necessarily. Therefore it is through the *jīva-tattva* that Kṛṣṇa's possession of potency (*vilāsa*) [is manifest] in the Kṛṣṇa-*tattva*. Without the *jīva-tattva*, Kṛṣṇa's full possession of potency could not be admitted. Where there are none to be ruled, there is no Ruler.

(Bhagavad-gītā 7.5)

অপরেয়মিতস্ত্বন্যাং প্রকৃতিং বিদ্ধি মে পরাম্ ।
জীবভূতাং মহাবাহো যয়েদং ধার্য্যতে জগৎ ॥ ১১৮ ॥

apareyam itas tv anyāṁ
inferior this beyond this but another
prakṛtiṁ viddhi me parām
nature know My superior
jīva-bhūtāṁ mahā-bāho
consisting of jīvas O mighty-armed
yayedaṁ dhāryate jagat
by which this is taken up the world

118 "This nature is inferior. But know, O mighty-armed, that I have another, superior nature, consisting of the jīvas, who take up this world for their own enjoyment." (Bhagavad-gītā, 7.5)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Earth, water, fire, air and ether — this is the gross world of the five elements; mind, intelligence and *ahaṅkāra* — the subtle (*liṅga*) world. *Prakṛti*, divided in these eight ways, is "inferior" (*aparā*), or "inert" (*jaḍā*); it is called *māyā-prakṛti*. Apart from it I have another, "superior *prakṛti*" (*parā-prakṛti*). This *prakṛti*, whose nature is the jīva, fills this world. The point is this: Bhagavān is the one Reality; He has a potency called *svarūpa*, or *ātma*. There is a potency that appears almost separate from this *svarūpa-śakti*, yet shows itself as its shadow; it is called *māyā-śakti*. The material universe, gross and subtle, is born of that māyā. Beyond it is the *jīva-tattva*. The jīva's pure being, pure *ahaṅkāra* and mental functions are all formed by a certain superior potency (*parā-śakti*) beyond māyā. So māyā had no authority at all in the making of the "*jīva*." When the jīva has entered māyā, a minute intelli-

gence and *ahaṅkāra* tinged with materiality appear in him — that alone is *māyā*'s work. When the jīva is cleansed of this connection with māyā and abides in his own *svarūpa*, this is called *mukti*. In *mukti* not even the *ahaṅkāra* made by māyā remains; but all the spiritual faculties natural to the jīva will be able to act in their pure form. Therefore the jīva is a particular potency of Bhagavān.

Anubhāṣya.

iyam aparā (insentient *prakṛti*, inferior because it is inert). **itaḥ** (than inert *prakṛti*) **anyām parām** (spiritual) **jīva-bhūtām** (whose nature is the *jīva*) **me** (My) **prakṛtim viddhi** (know). **he mahā-bāho**, **yayā** (by the conscious potency called the *jīva*) **idam** (inert) **jagat dhāryate** (is taken up as the object of its own enjoyment).

Cit, jīva and māyā — the three kinds of Viṣṇu's potency —

বিষ্ণুশক্তিঃ পরা প্রোক্তা ক্ষেত্রজ্ঞাখ্যা তথাপরা ।
অবিদ্যা-কর্ম্মসংজ্ঞান্যা তৃতীয়া শক্তিরিষ্যতে ॥ ১১৯ ॥

viṣṇu-śaktiḥ parā proktā
Viṣṇu's potency superior is declared
kṣetrajñākhyā tathā parā
called the knower of the field likewise superior
avidyā-karma-saṁjñānyā
called ignorance and karma another
tṛtīyā śaktir iṣyate
a third potency is held to be

119 "The potency of Viṣṇu is declared to be superior; the potency called the knower of the field (*kṣetrajña*) is likewise superior; and the other, called ignorance and karma, is held to be a third potency." (Viṣṇu Purāṇa, 6.7.61)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Viṣṇu's potency is of three kinds: the superior (*parā*), the *kṣetrajñā*, and the one called ignorance (*avidyā*). Viṣṇu's superior potency is *cit-śakti*; the *kṣetrajñā* potency is *jīva-śakti* (it is said to be "other" [distinct] from māyā, that is, *avidyā*); and the potency of *avidyā*, which is called *karma*, is named *māyā*.

Anubhāṣya.

viṣṇu-śaktiḥ (Viṣṇu's *svarūpa-śakti*) **parā** (spiritual by nature) **proktā**; **tathā aparā** (a certain other potency) **kṣetrajñākhyā** (is called *jīva-śakti*); **anyā tṛtīyā śaktiḥ avidyā-karma-saṁjñā** (the one called both *avidyā* and karma — the *māyā-śakti*) **iṣyate**.

To consider the Lord, like the jīva, to be full of ignorance — this too is Māyāvāda —

হেন জীবতত্ত্ব লঞা লিখি' পরতত্ত্ব ।
আচ্ছন্ন করিল শ্রেষ্ঠ ঈশ্বর-মহত্ত্ব ॥ ১২০ ॥

hena jīva-tattva lañā likhi' para-tattva
such the jīva-truth taking writing the supreme truth
ācchanna karila śreṣṭha īśvara-mahattva
covering he made the highest of Īśvara greatness

120 Yet the Ācārya took such a jīva and declared it to be the Supreme Truth, and so he hid the supreme greatness of the Lord.

The Brahma-sūtra accepts only the doctrine of the transformation of potency (śakti-pariṇāma-vāda) —

ব্যাসের সূত্রেতে কহে 'পরিণাম'-বাদ ।
ব্যাস ভ্রান্ত — বলি' তার উঠাইল বিবাদ ॥ ১২১ ॥

vyāsera sūtrete kahe 'pariṇāma'-vāda
of Vyāsa in the sūtras is told 'transformation'-doctrine
vyāsa bhrānta — bali' tāra uṭhāila vivāda
Vyāsa mistaken saying his raised dispute

121 In Vyāsa's sūtras the doctrine of transformation (*pariṇāma-vāda*) is taught; but Śaṅkara said that Vyāsa was mistaken and raised a dispute.

Anubhāṣya.

Setting out to describe the nature of the Lord, the jīva and *prakṛti* as indescribable and to explain it in terms of ignorance, Śaṅkara concealed the transcendent supremacy of the Lord.

Śrī Rāmānujapāda writes in the *Vedānta-sāra*: “Objection: the statement ‘In the beginning all this was the Ātmā alone’ establishes oneness before creation. How, then, can Nārāyaṇa, qualified by subtle spirit and matter, be the cause? Answer: [it is said:] ‘That from which these beings are born, by which, once born, they live, and into which, departing, they enter.’ What is taught here is that beings, having given up their gross forms and taken on subtle ones, abide in Brahman — not that their own nature ceases. For [in the *śruti*] we hear: ‘The *akṣara* dissolves into darkness (*tamas*); darkness becomes one with the supreme Deity’ — that is, *prakṛti*, called by the word *tamas*, becomes one with the Paramātmā. To become one is to exist without being perceived separately; and that is the meaning of the word *laya* (dissolution): as birds dissolve into a tree, and deer into a forest.”

You may ask: “Before the creation of the world only the Ātmā existed (*Bṛhad-āraṇyaka* 1.4.1); how then can Nārāyaṇa, possessed of subtle spiritual and material potencies, be the root cause of the world?” The answer can be given thus. The statement of the *Taittirīya*, “He from whom these beings were born, by whom they are sustained, and into whom they enter” (*Taittirīya*, *Bhṛgu-vallī* 1), shows that beings give up their gross material forms, are released from them, take on subtle forms and [so] abide in Brahman, but their *svarūpa* is not destroyed. For when the imperishable soul dissolves into *prakṛti*, called by the word *tamas*, *prakṛti* becomes nondifferent (one) with Brahman. At that time *prakṛti* is not perceived separately from Brahman, and so the existence of *prakṛti* abides in Brahman itself. This is what the word *laya* means. An example: just as birds in a tree or animals in a forest dissolve into the tree or the forest, that is, are hidden within it.

Śrī Vedavyāsa, the author of the *Brahma-sūtra*, says: “The *ānandamaya* [is Brahman], because [this] is repeated” (*Brahma-sūtra* 1.1.12). In connection with this sūtra, while explaining the sūtra “And [scripture] teaches its union with that in it” (*Brahma-sūtra* 1.1.19), Śrī Śaṅkara wrote what may be paraphrased thus: “The statement about the *ānandamaya* lacks the word ‘Brahman,’ so the *ānandamaya* cannot be called the principal Brahman. If the *ānandamaya* were called ‘Brahman,’ then, since it has parts, one would have to speak of a Brahman possessed of features. Yet at the end of the statement about the *ānandamaya* the featureless Brahman is spoken of. If one says that in the word *ānandamaya* the suffix *mayaṭ* means abundance — ‘abounding in bliss’ (the sense in which the *bhāgavatas*, who teach spiritual variety, have used it) — then it follows that suffering also exists in it. For the word ‘abundant’ is used according to predominance, not according to scarcity. The *śruti* does not repeat (*abhyāsa*, repeated mention) the ‘*ānandamaya*’

but repeats '*ānanda*' alone — precisely because the *ānandamaya* is not 'pure Brahman.' Had it been established that the *ānandamaya* is Brahman, then perhaps the repetition of '*ānanda*' alone might have been taken as a repetition of the *ānandamaya*. But since the *ānandamaya* is connected with parts, it is certain that it is not Brahman. For all these reasons, and because in *śrutis* such as 'Brahman is *ānanda*' the word *ānanda* is used of the Supreme Brahman, it is clear that in other *śrutis* too what is repeated is '*ānanda* alone, Brahman,' not '*ānandamaya*.' True, in the *śruti* '*ānandamayam ātmānam*' we see the *ānandamaya* itself repeated; but it stands in the series with the *annamaya* and the rest, and so the *ānandamaya* cannot denote pure Brahman. Near the statement about the *ānandamaya* there are the words 'He desired: may I become many'; but the *ānandamaya* has no close connection with pure Brahman, and so it does not denote pure Brahman. The statement that follows, 'He is *rasa*,' and the rest depends on that [pure Brahman] and so does not point to the *ānandamaya*. Since there are no words indicating parts, such as 'joy is His head,' it is certain that the principal Brahman is '*ānanda*,' not '*ānandamaya*.' You may say: does not that *śruti* intend the Brahman possessed of features? The answer: you cannot say so — that is refuted by the *śrutis* which say He is 'beyond speech and mind.' Therefore the suffix *mayaṭ* in the word *ānandamaya* indicates transformation (*vikāra*), not abundance."

Thus Śrīpāda Śaṅkara, in explaining these sūtras, wanted to remove the suffix *mayaṭ*, that is, to show that it is useless or superfluous — and what effort he made to repeat one and the same point again and again in sūtras 12–19! On this Śrīmad Jīva Prabhu says in his *Sarva-saṁvādinī*: "If one secretly intends [to show] that the author of the sūtras did not know the meaning of Vedānta, and, with an artfulness that betrays one's own cleverness in correcting his mistake, explains that sūtra on the *ānandamaya* thus — 'In [the passage] "*ānandamaya*" and so on, Brahman, principal in its own right, is taught [by the words] "Brahman is the tail, the foundation"' — and in the sūtra on *vikāra* (1.1.13) explains the word *vikāra* as 'part' and the word *prācurya* as 'similarity,' then it would follow that the author of the sūtras did not know the meaning of words, since by those words he would not be expressing those meanings. That the words — the suffix *mayaṭ*, *vikāra* and *prācurya*, stated one after another — have some other sense would not occur even to a child."

Reading Śaṅkara's commentary, one gets the impression that his hidden aim is, as it were, [to show] that Śrī Vedavyāsa, the author of the sūtras, could not understand the meaning of Vedānta. So Śrī Śaṅkara, on the pretext of correcting the mistake of the ācārya Śrī Vedavyāsa, the author of the sūtras, used his own cleverness and art-

fully explained the sūtra on the *ānandamaya* thus: "Among the statements of the *śruti* beginning with '*ānandamaya*,' the principal Brahman is 'taught' in the statement 'Brahman is the tail, the foundation'; and in sūtra 1.1.13 I shall explain the word *vikāra* as 'part' and the word *prācurya* as 'similarity.'" Explained this way, it follows that the author of the sūtras (Vyāsa) had no knowledge of words, since the words he used do not yield those meanings of Vedānta. What other meaning could the words *vikāra*, *prācurya* and the rest, derived from the suffix *mayaṭ* and stated one after another, possibly have? Even a child can see this! In other words, it is easy to understand that to give the suffix *mayaṭ* any meaning other than "transformation" and "abundance" is a plain error.

See Madhya 6.170–175 and Madhya 25.40–41.

The "vivarta-vāda" of the Māyāvādī, who considers his guru mistaken —

পরিণাম-বাদে ঈশ্বর হয়েন বিকারী ।
এত কহি' 'বিবর্ত্ত'-বাদ স্থাপনা যে করি ॥ ১২২ ॥

pariṇāma-vāde īśvara hayena vikārī
in the transformation-doctrine Īśvara becomes changeable
eta kahi' 'vivarta'-vāda sthāpanā ye kari
thus saying 'appearance'-doctrine establishment which he made

122 He argued that under the doctrine of transformation the Lord would be subject to change, and on that ground he established *vivarta-vāda*, the doctrine of illusion.

The basis of vivarta —

বস্তুতঃ পরিণাম-বাদ — সেই সে প্রমাণ ।
দেহে আত্মবুদ্ধি — হয় বিবর্ত্তের স্থান ॥ ১২৩ ॥

vastutaḥ pariṇāma-vāda — sei se pramāṇa
in reality the transformation-doctrine that alone the authority
dehe ātma-buddhi — haya vivartera sthāna
in the body the sense of self is of vivarta the place

123 In truth the doctrine of transformation alone is authoritative; illusion lies in taking the body for the self.

Refutation of vivarta-vāda: (1) Bhagavān possesses inconceivable potency —

অবিচিন্ত্য-শক্তিযুক্ত শ্রীভগবান্ ।
ইচ্ছায় জগৎরূপে পায় পরিণাম ॥ ১২৪ ॥

avicintya-śakti-yukta śrī-bhagavān
with inconceivable potency endowed Śrī Bhagavān
icchāya jagat-rūpe pāya pariṇāma
by His will in the form of the world undergoes transformation

124 Śrī Bhagavān possesses inconceivable potency, and by His own will He is transformed into the world.

(2) The example of the material cintāmaṇi stone —

তথাপি অচিন্ত্যশক্ত্যে হয় অবিকারী ।
প্রাকৃত চিন্তামণি তাহে দৃষ্টান্ত ধরি ॥ ১২৫ ॥

tathāpi acintya-śaktye haya avikārī
still by inconceivable potency He is unchanged
prākṛta cintāmaṇi tāhe dṛṣṭānta dhari
the material cintāmaṇi in this as an example we hold

125 Yet by that same inconceivable potency He remains unchanged. We find an example of this even in this world — the *cintāmaṇi* stone.

The cintāmaṇi, which produces heaps of jewels, remains unchanged —

নানা রত্ন-রাশি হয় চিন্তামণি হৈতে ।
তথাপিহ মণি রহে স্বরূপে অবিকৃতে ॥ ১২৬ ॥

nānā ratna-rāśi haya cintāmaṇi haite
various heaps of jewels come from the cintāmaṇi
tathāpiha maṇi rahe svarūpe avikṛte
yet the gem remains in its own nature unchanged

126 Heaps of various jewels come from the *cintāmaṇi*, yet the gem itself remains unchanged in its nature.

Anubhāṣya.

Śrī Jīva Prabhu writes in the *Paramātma-sandarbha* (section 58): "For in that doctrine the view is that all duality, beginning with the jīvas, is imagined through ignorance alone in Brahman, which is one's own nature. But Brahman — pure consciousness, without ego, free of any other attribute, distinct from everything — can be neither the shelter of ignorance, nor its object, nor the cause of error. Yet inconceivable potency is possible in Him, since He is a supreme and transcendent Reality. This is seen even in the *cintāmaṇi* and the like. [Brahman's potency], like a medicine that cures disorders of all three humours, holds even mutually contradictory qualities in Him; by it, although He is without parts and so on, He is acknowledged to have parts and so on. For this, the word [of scripture] is the evidence. It is: 'The ancient Puruṣa has wondrous potencies, and others have no such potencies,' and so on, in the *Śvetāśvatara Upaniṣad* and elsewhere; 'the Self, the Lord, possessed of thousands of potencies beyond reasoning' (*Bhāgavatam* 3.33.3), and so on, in the *Śrī Bhāgavatam* and elsewhere. So too the *Brahma-sūtra* (2.1.28): 'For in the Self too it is so, since [in Him] there is variety.' Therefore, even on the plea that duality cannot otherwise be explained, ignorance and the like cannot be imagined in Brahman — simply because it is impossible. And since inconceivable potency in Brahman is grasped by reason and heard in the *śruti*, the plea 'duality cannot otherwise be explained' falls away. In the end, then, inconceivable potency alone remains as what explains duality. Therefore, although the Paramātmā is by nature changeless and so on, by His inconceivable potency transformation and the like take place — into the shape of the universe and so on — just as the *cintāmaṇi* yields every desired object and the magnet moves iron. Śrī Bādarāyaṇa accepted this: 'But on the basis of *śruti*, for [this] rests on the word' (*Brahma-sūtra* 2.1.27). Hence, since He has such potency, it is also wrong to take the word *māyā*, as in worldly usage, to mean the art of sorcery (*indra-jāla*). It means the potency that creates wondrous variety: 'that by which the manifold is measured out, that is, fashioned.' Therefore the conclusion of scripture is the transformation of the Paramātmā Himself. *** Here He, remaining untransformed, is transformed by inconceivable potency; and it is understood that He is transformed only in the form of the potency called *dravya* (substance) — an expansion (*vyūha*) of His *svarūpa*, which appears as pure being alone — and not in His *svarūpa*. Just like the *cintāmaṇi*.** * That is why we sometimes hear that the material cause [of the world] is Brahman, and sometimes that it is *pradhāna*. *** Earlier, when one saw water, a mental image in the form of water arose. While there is no occasion for it, it lies asleep, but it awakens on seeing something similar; and then,**

without examining the difference, [the mind] arbitrarily imposes [water] on it, taking them as one. So it is not the water that is false, nor the image in the form of water made of its memory, nor the similar thing such as a mirage: only the imposition that identifies them is false, since it does not accord with reality. And in a dream — by the rule 'But [the dream] is mere māyā, since its nature is not fully manifest' (*Brahma-sūtra* 3.2.3) — the Paramātmā's māyā imposes the separate things on a state of mind shaped like things seen in waking, just as before. So in reality nothing anywhere is false. Only such an imposition of that [world] on the pure self or on the Paramātmā is false — not that the universe is false. Moreover, *vivarta* is mentioned in the sections on knowledge and the like, and so is secondary; whereas *pariṇāma* is mentioned in its own section and so is primary; and since it is mentioned in both — in the sections on knowledge and the like as well — its strength is established by the maxim of the tongs (*sandaṁśa-nyāya*). Therefore it is understood that the purport of the *Śrī Bhāgavatam* is *pariṇāma* itself."

In the *Paramātma-sandarbha* [it is said]: relying on *vivarta*, that is, on the doctrine of falsity, they claim that all *tattvas* that have a second existence — the jīva and the rest — are imagined through ignorance in Brahman's own *svarūpa*. But Brahman is devoid of any other attribute, distinct from everything, free of ego, pure consciousness; so He can never be the shelter of ignorance, nor that towards which ignorance is directed, nor the cause of error. Brahman is a supreme and transcendent Reality, and so He can have a potency inconceivable to puny human beings. If transcendent power is seen even in material things such as the *cintāmaṇi*, then such power certainly exists in Brahman. When the three humours — *vāta*, *kapha* and *pitta* — afflict a patient all at once, a medicine is prescribed to correct the mutually opposed elements of the body. In the same way the potency that holds three mutually opposed qualities [allows us to accept] that Brahman, though formless and so on, possesses limbs and so on. There is Vedic evidence for this: "The eternal Puruṣa possesses wondrous potencies; others have no such potencies" — so says the *Śvetāśvatara*. And the *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* and other works say: "The Self is the Lord, possessed of thousands of inconceivable potencies." And the *Brahma-sūtra*: "In the Self there is such variety." Even though duality may find no explanation in Brahman, ignorance and the like still cannot be imagined in Brahman, since that is impossible. "Inconceivable potency in Brahman agrees with reason and is confirmed by the *śruti*, so the plea 'duality cannot otherwise be explained' has fallen away; what remains to explain duality is inconceivable potency alone.

Therefore, although the Paramātmā is changeless by nature, by the power of His inconceivable potency transformation and the like take place into the shape of the universe. The *cintāmaṇi* does not change, yet it can yield every desired object; the magnet does not change, yet it can attract and move iron and so on. In the same way Brahman does not change: only Brahman's potency, which is capable of change, changes and is transformed into the shape of the universe. Śrī Bādarāyaṇa accepted this in the *Brahma-sūtra*. And since Brahman has such potency, it is wrong to take the word *māyā*, as in worldly usage, to mean the art of sorcery. This māyā creates variety, and so it is established that the word means the potency that produces wondrous variety. Therefore the conclusion of scripture is that this universe is the transformation of the Paramātmā Himself. *** Here what is transformed is the untransformed real Entity — by the power of inconceivable potency. So what is transformed is only the potency called *dravya*, an unfolding of the *svarūpa* of that Entity, which appears as pure being alone; the *svarūpa* itself is not transformed. So the *cintāmaṇi* exerts its power, yet itself undergoes no change at all.** * That is why, as we hear, some say that the material cause of this world is 'Brahman,' while others say it is '*pradhāna*.' *** Earlier, when one saw water, a notion of it arose. While there is no occasion for it, that notion sleeps, but on seeing something similar it awakens. If, without examining that thing, one arbitrarily imposes on it identity with the earlier thing, then it is not the water that becomes false, nor the image in the form of water made of its memory, nor the water-like thing such as a mirage — only the imposition of identity with water is untrue, that is, false. And in a dream too, by the rule '[the dream] is mere māyā; its nature is not fully manifest,' the Paramātmā's māyā, just as before, imposes identity with things on a state of mind shaped like things perceived (seen) in waking. Therefore in reality nothing is false. Only such an imposition on the pure self or on the Paramātmā is false; the universe is not false.** * Further, the examples of *vivarta* are mentioned among the sections on knowledge and the like, and so are secondary; *pariṇāma-vāda* is set forth in its own section, and so is primary; and since it is set forth in both — in the sections on knowledge and the like as well — its strength is established by the maxim of the tongs. Therefore it is known that the purport of the *Śrī Bhāgavatam* is the transformation of potency (*śakti-pariṇāma*)."

(3) Even when His potency is transformed, He Himself remains unchanged —

প্রাকৃত-বস্তুতে যদি অচিন্ত্যশক্তি হয় ।
ঈশ্বরের অচিন্ত্যশক্তি, — ইথে কি বিস্ময় ॥ ১২৭ ॥

prākṛta-vastute yadi acintya-śakti haya
in a material thing if inconceivable potency is
īśvarera acintya-śakti, — ithe ki vismaya
of Īśvara inconceivable potency in this what wonder

127 If even a material thing possesses inconceivable power, what wonder is there in the inconceivable potency of the Lord?

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

The *jīva-tattva* is a particular potency. If one tries to establish the *jīva-tattva* not as atomic consciousness (*aṇu-caitanya*) but as "Brahman," the conclusion will certainly be mistaken. Śrī Śaṅkarācārya, carrying out the Lord's order, intended to conceal the Lord's sovereignty; so he established the oneness of the *jīva-tattva* with the Supreme Truth (*para-tattva*) and preached a mistaken conclusion. In fact, Vyāsa's sūtras accept the doctrine of the transformation (of potency) — (*śakti-*)*pariṇāma-vāda*. The ācārya raised the argument: "If *pariṇāma-vāda* is accepted, the Lord must be said to undergo change." He reasoned: "If *pariṇāma-vāda* is admitted, Vyāsa will have to be admitted to have 'erred,'" and so he established *vivarta-vāda*. In his commentary on the fourteenth sūtra of the first *pāda* of the second chapter of the *Brahma-sūtra* — "It is not other [than the cause], according to the word *ārambhaṇa* and the rest" — he cited such Vedic statements as "Change is only a verbal designation, a name" (*Chāndogya* 6.1.4) and argued that *pariṇāma-vāda* is a faulty doctrine of change (*vikāra-vāda*). In reality, the *Brahma-sūtra* presents *pariṇāma-vāda* thus: by the mere will of the Lord, His inconceivable potency is transformed into effects. The definition of *pariṇāma* is: "*Vikāra* is said to be the perception [of a thing] as other while it is real." When from one real *tattva* another real *tattva* arises, and it is perceived as a different thing, that is *vikāra*, that is, *pariṇāma*. "Brahman" is a real Entity; from Him there have arisen separately a real entity, the "*jīva*," and a real entity, the "material universe of māyā." This understanding is called the *vikāra*, or *pariṇāma*, of Brahman. An example of *pariṇāma*: "milk" is a real substance, and it changes into another real substance, "curd." Vedic statements such as "All this has That as its soul" (*Chāndogya* 6.8.7) leave no doubt that the world is Brahman. Brahman has an inconceivable potency;

this is established by the Vedic statement "His supreme potency is heard to be manifold" (*Śvetāśvatara* 6.8). By that potency Brahman's real nature is transformed into the world — and no fault can attach to such a conclusion. From the statements of the *Chāndogya* — "In the beginning, my dear, all this was Being alone, one without a second" (6.2.1), "It glanced: may I become many, may I be born" (6.2.3), "All these creatures, my dear, are rooted in Being, abide in Being, are established in Being" (6.8.4), "All this has That as its soul" (6.8.7) — it is well known that this Brahman, by His own superior potency, is transformed into this world of spirit and matter. The world and the jīva are *upādeya* (what is made from the material), and Brahman is the *upādāna* (the material cause). The Vedic statement "That from which these beings are born" (*Taittirīya, Bhṛgu-vallī* 1) accepts that Brahman is the material cause and that the jīva and matter are made from Him. One who has not grasped the true essence of *pariṇāma-vāda* does not understand that this "world" and the "*jīva*" are separate real *tattvas*. From such statements as "All these creatures, my dear, are rooted in Being, abide in Being" (*Chāndogya* 6.8.4), it is clear that the "*jīva*" and the "material world," the jīva's dwelling, are indeed real. To imagine the jīva and the world as false, like a snake in a rope or silver in a shell, out of a groundless fear that Brahman would then turn out to be subject to change — this is mere deception. True, the *Māṇḍūkya* and other Vedas give the examples of "a snake in a rope" and "silver in a shell," but these have their own particular fields of application. The jīva is a pure particle of spirit. The jīva in a human body identifies himself with this material body — that is the place of *vivarta*. *Vivarta* is explained thus: "*Vivarta* is said to be the perception [of a thing] as other when it is not so in reality." To take a thing for what it is not — that is *vivarta*. For the jīva, *vivarta* is a great defect: the conditioned jīva is stained by this fault of false perception (*vivarta-buddhi*). To impose such a fault of *vivarta* on the original *tattva* of the universe and on the *jīva-tattva* is utterly worthless. Such an error arises only when one forgets the inconceivable potency. How Bhagavān has transformed into the world can be illustrated by a simple example. Many say that in the material world there is a treasure, the stone *cintāmaṇi*: it produces heaps of various jewels, yet itself remains unchanged. If a material thing has such an inconceivable power, what is surprising in the Lord's having an inconceivable potency that surpasses it infinitely in its qualities?

The praṇava, seed of the tree of the Vedas, is the great statement (mahā-vākya)

and the very form of the Lord —

‘প্রণব’ সে মহাবাক্য বেদের নিদান ।
ঈশ্বরস্বরূপ প্রণব — সর্ব্ববিশ্ব-ধাম ॥ ১২৮ ॥

‘praṇava’ se mahāvākya vedera nidāna
‘praṇava’ that great utterance of the Vedas the source
īśvara-svarūpa praṇava — sarva-viśva-dhāma
the Lord’s own form praṇava of all universes the abode

128 The *praṇava* (oṁ) is the great utterance, the source of the Vedas; the *praṇava* is the Lord Himself in sound, the abode of all the universes.

Anubhāṣya.

In the *Gītā*: “Whoever departs, leaving the body, uttering the single syllable *Om* — Brahman — and remembering Me, attains the supreme goal” (8.13); “[I am] what is to be known, the purifier, the syllable *Om*” (9.17); “*Om tat sat* — this is remembered as the threefold designation of Brahman” (17.23). In the *Chāndogya Upaniṣad* (1.1.1, 1.4.1): “One should worship the syllable *Om* as the *udgītha*, for one sings the *udgītha* beginning with *Om*. Here is its explanation”; (*Chāndogya* 1.5.1): “What is the *udgītha* is the *praṇava*; what is the *praṇava* is the *udgītha*”; (*Atharva-śikhā* 2): “It makes all the life-breaths bow (*praṇāvayati*) to the Paramātmā; therefore it is the *praṇava*. The *praṇava* abides in four forms; it is the source of the Vedas and of the gods, the object of meditation; it holds all together and carries one across all sorrows and fears, because it delivers; [pervading] all, it is Viṣṇu; it conquers all”;[5] (*Māṇḍūkya* 1): “The syllable *Om* is all this. Here is its explanation: past, present and future — all this is *Om* alone; and whatever else lies beyond the three times is also *Om* alone”; (*Taittirīya, Śikṣā*, ch. 8): “*Om* is Brahman. *Om* is all this. With *Om* they sing the Sāmans. With *Om* a brāhmaṇa, about to recite [the Veda], says, ‘May I attain Brahman’ — and he attains Brahman.”

In the *Śrī Bhagavat-sandarbha* (section 48): “The *śruti* says of the *praṇava*: ‘*Om* is the nearest name of Brahman: as soon as it is uttered, it carries one across the fear of worldly existence; therefore it is called *tāra*, the deliverer.’ *** Therefore the name is the very *svarūpa* of Bhagavān. It is also clearly said in the *Śrī Nārada-pañcarātra* about the eight-syllable [mantra]: ‘Clearly, Bhagavān Himself — Nārāyaṇa directly — abides in [people’s] mouths in the form of the eight sylla-

bles.' And in the *Māṇḍūkya Upaniṣad* (4.4–7) about the *praṇava*: '*Om* is all this. The syllable *Om* is all this.' 'The *praṇava* is indeed the Supreme Brahman, and the *praṇava* is held to be the Supreme. The *praṇava* has nothing before it, nothing within, nothing without, nothing after; it is imperishable. The *praṇava* is the beginning, the middle and the end of all. Knowing the *praṇava* thus, one attains it at once. Know the *praṇava* to be the Lord, abiding in the heart of everyone. One who understands *Oṁkāra* as all-pervading is wise and does not grieve. It is without measure and of infinite measure; in it duality comes to rest; it is auspicious. One who has known *Oṁkāra* is a sage, not an ordinary person.' One should not think that, since such things are possible only for the Supreme Lord, the words about a mere letter are only praise. For the same *śruti* accepts the sense that, like the other avatāras, this is an avatāra of the Supreme Lord Himself in the form of sound; and this is possible because the sound is nondifferent from Him. Therefore the name and the Bearer of the name are nondifferent."

The *Śrī Bhagavat-sandarbha* [says]: the *śruti* says of the *praṇava* that *Om* is the nearest (the sweetest) of all the names of the Supreme Brahman: from the moment one begins to utter it, it saves the jīva from the fear of worldly existence; therefore He is also called "Tāra." [Śrīdhara Svāmipāda, at the beginning of his own commentary on the *Bhāgavatam*, called the *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam tārāṅkura*, "the sprout of Tāra," because it begins with *Om*.] So the holy name is directly the *svarūpa* of Bhagavān. About the eight-syllable mantra the *Śrī Nārada-pañcarātra* says clearly: "It is well known that Bhagavān Śrī Nārāyaṇa Himself directly appears in the mouth of the jīva in the form of the eight syllables." And about the *praṇava* the *Māṇḍūkya Upaniṣad* says: "All that is seen by spiritual vision is *Oṁkāra*, the syllable *Om*." "The *praṇava* is another appearance of Brahman; He is called the Supreme Reality. He has nothing before Him, is unbounded, has nothing outside Him, is supreme and imperishable; He is the beginning, the middle and the end of all. Knowing the *praṇava* thus, one tastes immortality. Know that the *praṇava*, abiding in the heart of everyone, is the *svarūpa* of the Lord. As soon as a wise person understands *Oṁkāra* as all-pervading — *vibhu*, that is, the *svarūpa* of Viṣṇu — he no longer needs to grieve; that is, he is no longer a śūdra.[25] He is without material measure, yet possesses infinite measure; through Him the material knowledge of duality subsides and nondual knowledge is attained; therefore He is the supreme good itself." One should not think that such auspicious works are possible only for the Supreme Lord as an avatāra, and that therefore such statements about a material sound or letter contain no real truth and are mere praise. In fact, like the other

avatāras of the Supreme Lord, this *praṇava* too is His avatāra in the form of sound. This sense is accepted on the very strength of the *śruti* statements quoted above, and since the *praṇava* is nondifferent from Him, this is possible; so this sense alone is correct. Therefore there is no doubt that the name of Bhagavān and the Bearer of the name, Bhagavān, are nondifferent.

Om, or the *praṇava*, is the *mahā-vākya*, the root of the Vedas. The *praṇava* is placed at the beginning and at the end of every Vedic mantra. The *praṇava* is the very form of the Lord. "By the sound *a* Kṛṣṇa is denoted, the sole Master of all the worlds; by the sound *u* Rādhā is denoted; *m* denotes the jīva."

The Lord is what is denoted (vācya), the praṇava is what denotes (vācaka); "You are That" and similar statements only illumine one part of the Vedas —

সর্ব্বাশ্রয় ঈশ্বরের করি প্রণব উদ্দেশ ।
'তত্ত্বমসি' বাক্য হয় বেদের এক দেশ ॥ ১২৯ ॥

sarvāśraya īśvarera kari praṇava uddeśa
the shelter of all of Īśvara makes praṇava indication
'tat tvam asi' vākya haya vedera eka deśa
'tat tvam asi' the utterance is of the Veda one part

129 The *praṇava* points to the Lord, the shelter of all, whereas the utterance *tat tvam asi* is one particular statement of the Veda.

Anubhāṣya.
The *śruti* "You are That" (*tat tvam asi*) is found in the *Chāndogya Upaniṣad*, in the sixth *prapāṭhaka*, in the eighth to the sixteenth *khaṇḍas*: "He is the Self; you are That, Śvetaketu." "You are That" is one of the four Vedic "great statements" (*mahā-vākyas*) introduced by Śaṅkara.

'প্রণব' মহাবাক্য — তাহা করি' আচ্ছাদন ।
মহাবাক্যে করি' 'তত্ত্বমসি'র স্থাপন ॥ ১৩০ ॥

'praṇava' mahā-vākya — tāhā kari' ācchādana
'praṇava' the great utterance that making covering
mahāvākye kari' 'tat tvam asi'ra sthāpana
as the great utterance making of 'tat tvam asi' establishment

130 The *praṇava* is the great utterance; but he covered this and set up *tat tvam asi* as the great utterance instead.

The Vedas and other scriptures, in their direct meaning (abhidhā-vṛtti), acknowledge Kṛṣṇa alone —

সর্ব্ববেদসূত্রে করে কৃষ্ণের অভিধান ।
মুখ্যবৃত্তি ছাড়ি' কৈল লক্ষণা-ব্যাখ্যান ॥ ১৩১ ॥

sarva-veda-sūtre kare kṛṣṇera abhidhāna
in all the Vedas and sūtras is made of Kṛṣṇa the naming
mukhya-vṛtti chāḍi' kaila lakṣaṇā-vyākhyāna
the primary sense abandoning he made secondary explanation

131 All the Vedas and sūtras name Kṛṣṇa in their primary sense; but he abandoned the primary sense and explained them by the secondary one (*lakṣaṇā*).

Anubhāṣya.
"In the Vedas, in the *Rāmāyaṇa*, in the Purāṇas and in the *Mahābhārata* — in the beginning, at the end and in the middle — Hari is sung everywhere."

The evidence of the word, dependent on nothing else, is supreme —

স্বতঃপ্রমাণ বেদ — প্রমাণ-শিরোমণি ।
লক্ষণা করিলে স্বতঃপ্রমাণতা-হানি ॥ ১৩২ ॥

svataḥ-pramāṇa veda — pramāṇa-śiromaṇi
self-evident the Veda of proofs the crest-jewel
lakṣaṇā karile svataḥ-pramāṇatā-hāni
by lakṣaṇā if one makes of self-evidence the loss

132 The Veda is self-evident, the crest-jewel of all proofs; interpreted by the secondary sense, it loses that self-evidence.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
The root statement of the Vedas is the *praṇava*; therefore it alone is the great statement (*mahā-vākya*) that denotes Brahman. The *praṇava* is the word that reveals the *svarūpa* of the Lord; therefore it is the Lord's eternal name and points to the Lord

— *sarva-viśva-dhāma*, the shelter of all. To call "*mahā-vākyas*" such statements as "You are That" (*Chāndogya* 6.8.7), "All this is what this Self is," "All this is Brahman" (*Bṛhad-āraṇyaka* 2.5.1), "All this is the Self" (*Chāndogya* 7.25.2) and "There is no diversity here" (*Kaṭha* 2.1.11; *Bṛhad-āraṇyaka* 4.4.19) is a grave error. For the chief among them, "You are That," is only a partial statement: what the words "You are That" teach covers only one part of the Vedas. A *mahā-vākya* is what covers the Vedas as a whole; therefore nothing but the *praṇava* can be a "*mahā-vākya*."[5] Concealing this truth, Śrī Śaṅkarācārya called "You are That" a *mahā-vākya*. Relying on this invented *mahā-vākya*, he everywhere in the Vedas abandoned the primary meaning, that is, *abhidhā-vṛtti*, and explained them by *lakṣaṇā*, the secondary meaning. In this way he rejected without any reason the way all the Vedas and sūtras reveal the Kṛṣṇa-*tattva*. The Vedas are their own evidence (*svataḥ-pramāṇa*); so to impose a figurative sense (*lakṣaṇā*) on their words is merely to destroy the authority of evidence that is self-established.

Anubhāṣya.
See the *Anubhāṣya* on Ādi 7.107.

Śaṅkara's explanation rests on lakṣaṇā-vṛtti and is therefore invented —

এইমত প্রতিসূত্রে সহজার্থ ছাড়িয়া ।
গৌণার্থ ব্যাখ্যা করে সব কল্পনা করিয়া ॥ ১৩৩ ॥

ei mata pratisūtre sahajārtha chāḍiyā
in this way in every sūtra the natural meaning abandoning
gauṇārtha vyākhyā kare saba kalpanā kariyā
the secondary meaning explanation he makes all imagining

133 So in every sūtra he abandoned the natural meaning and explained it by a secondary one, inventing it all himself."

The Lord refutes Śaṅkara's commentary on each sūtra —

এইমতে প্রতিসূত্রে করেন দূষণ ।
শুনি' চমৎকার হৈল সন্ন্যাসীর গণ ॥ ১৩৪ ॥

ei mate pratisūtre karena dūṣaṇa
in this way in every sūtra He makes fault-finding
śuni' camatkāra haila sannyāsīra gaṇa
hearing astonished became of the sannyāsīs the company

134 In this way He showed the faults in the commentary on every sūtra, and the sannyāsīs were astonished to hear it.

The sannyāsīs' astonishment, their admission, and their loyalty to their sampradāya —

সকল সন্ন্যাসী কহে, — 'শুনহ শ্রীপাদ ।
তুমি যে খণ্ডিলে অর্থ, এ নহে বিবাদ ॥ ১৩৫ ॥

sakala sannyāsī kahe, — 'śunaha śrīpāda
all the sannyāsīs say listen Śrīpāda
tumi ye khaṇḍile artha, e nahe vivāda
You which have refuted the meaning this is not a matter of dispute

135 All the sannyāsīs said, "Listen, Śrīpāda: the meaning You have refuted is beyond dispute.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
O Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya! You presented these arguments and refuted Śaṅkara's interpretation; this is no empty dispute (*vivāda*) — that is, a fortunate person accepts it as "the truth."

আচার্য্য-কল্পিত অর্থ, — ইহা সবে জানি ।
সম্প্রদায়-অনুরোধে তত্ত্ব ইহা মানি ॥ ১৩৬ ॥

ācārya-kalpita artha, — ihā sabe jāni
by the Ācārya imagined the meaning this all we know
sampradāya-anurodhe tattva ihā māni
of the sampradāya out of deference the truth this we accept

136 We all know that the meaning is the Ācārya's own invention; yet out of deference to our sampradāya we accept it as the truth.

Anubhāṣya.

See Madhya 25.46–48.

The Lord is asked to explain by the direct meaning (abhidhā-vṛtti) —

মুখ্যার্থ ব্যাখ্যা কর, দেখি তোমার বল ।'
মুখ্যার্থে লাগা'ল প্রভু সূত্রসকল ॥ ১৩৭ ॥

mukhyārtha vyākhyā kara, dekhi tomāra bala'
the primary meaning explanation make let us see Your power
mukhyārthe lāgā'la prabhu sūtra-sakala
in the primary meaning set the Lord the sūtras all

137 Explain the primary meaning; let us see Your power." And the Lord set about explaining all the sūtras in their primary meaning:

The Lord's explanation: (1) Bhagavān Kṛṣṇa is the sambandha —

বৃহদ্বস্তু 'ব্রহ্ম' কহি — 'শ্রীভগবান্' ।
ষড়্বিধৈশ্বর্য্যপূর্ণ, পরতত্ত্বধাম ॥ ১৩৮ ॥

bṛhad-vastu 'brahma' kahi — 'śrī-bhagavān'
the great reality 'Brahman' we call 'Śrī Bhagavān'
ṣaḍ-vidhaiśvarya-pūrṇa, para-tattva-dhāma
with six kinds of majesty full of the Supreme Truth the abode

138 "The great reality called Brahman is Śrī Bhagavān, full of the six kinds of majesty, the abode of the Supreme Truth.

স্বরূপ-ঐশ্বর্য্যে তাঁর নাহি মায়াগন্ধ ।
সকল বেদের হয় ভগবান্ সে 'সম্বন্ধ' ॥ ১৩৯ ॥

svarūpa-aiśvarye tāṁra nāhi māyā-gandha
in His own form and majesty His there is not of māyā a trace
sakala vedera haya bhagavān se 'sambandha'
of all the Vedas is Bhagavān that 'sambandha'

139 In His own form and majesty there is not a trace of māyā; in all the Vedas Bhagavān is the *sambandha* — the One to whom everything is

related.

তাঁরে ‘নির্ব্বিশেষ’ কহি, চিচ্ছক্তি না মানি’ ।
অর্দ্ধ স্বরূপ না মানিলে পূর্ণতা হয় হানি ॥ ১৪০ ॥

tāṁre ‘nirviśeṣa’ kahi, cic-chakti nā māni’
Him ‘featureless’ we call the spiritual potency not accepting
ardha svarūpa nā mānile pūrṇatā haya hāni
half of His being not if one accepts fullness is harmed

140 To call Him featureless (*nirviśeṣa*) is to deny His spiritual potency; and one who does not accept half of His being diminishes His fullness.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
In the *Bṛhad-āraṇyaka* (5.1), in the statement “That is full…” and so on, the Supreme Truth, full of the six opulences, is called *bṛhad-vastu*, the great Reality. In the Purāṇas these characteristics are described by the word “Bhagavān”; therefore wherever the Vedas say “Brahman,” the word fulfils its purpose only when “Śrī Bhagavān” is put in its place. So in all the Vedas the one *sambandha* is Bhagavān. Bhagavān embraces even the quality of featurelessness, yet He is eternally possessed of features. To call Him “featureless” is to deny His *cit-śakti*. Brahman possesses *cit-śakti* — that is, possesses features; so if one does not accept half of His *svarūpa*, His fullness is impaired.

Anubhāṣya.
Śrī Rāmānujapāda writes in the *Vedārtha-saṅgraha*: “If it is asked, ‘How is it known that the very nature [of Brahman] is defined by knowledge as an attribute, and not that Brahman is mere knowledge?’ — [the answer is:] this is understood from the *śrutis* that speak of Him as the knower, such as ‘He who is all-knowing, all-wise’; from hundreds of *śrutis* such as ‘His supreme potency is heard to be manifold’ and ‘By what, my dear, should one know the knower?’; and also because knowledge is only an attribute, and a mere attribute without a substrate cannot be accepted as an independent entity. Therefore words such as ‘truth,’ ‘knowledge’ and so on establish Brahman as possessed of knowledge and so on — the very things that are their own meanings. And if in ‘*tat tvam*’ both words abandon their own meanings in order to point to the nature of an entity without features, that is an abandonment of the primary meaning. [It may be said:] ‘Since the purport [of the statement] is established to be oneness, there is no fault of *lakṣaṇā*, as in the words

"This is that very Devadatta."'[26] *** Moreover, a word gains its force as evidence because, by its very nature as words and sentences, it conveys differences of meaning and their particular relations; therefore it is incapable of conveying an entity without features, and for such an entity the word is not evidence. Words such as 'featureless' convey [meaning] in another way: of an entity known as possessed of some feature, they deny a feature known from some other thing."

(2) The means, or abhidheya, is sādhana-bhakti, beginning with hearing —

ভগবান্-প্রাপ্তিহেতু যে করি উপায় ।
শ্রবণাদি ভক্তি — কৃষ্ণপ্রাপ্ত্যের সহায় ॥ ১৪১ ॥

bhagavān-prāpti-hetu ye kari upāya
Bhagavān-attainment for which I make means
śravaṇādi bhakti — kṛṣṇa-prāptyera sahāya
hearing and the rest devotion of Kṛṣṇa's attainment the help

141 The means by which one attains Bhagavān is devotion beginning with hearing; it is what brings one to Kṛṣṇa.

সেই সর্ব্ববেদের 'অভিধেয়' নাম ।
সাধনভক্তি হৈতে হয় প্রেমের উদ্গম ॥ ১৪২ ॥

sei sarva-vedera 'abhidheya' nāma
that of all the Vedas 'abhidheya' the name
sādhana-bhakti haite haya premera udgama
from sādhana-bhakti is of prema the sprouting

142 All the Vedas call this the *abhidheya*, the means to be practised; from devotion in practice (*sādhana-bhakti*) prema springs up.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
To attain shelter at the feet of that Bhagavat-*tattva*, all the Vedas have determined *sādhana-bhakti* to be the *abhidheya*. It is from the ninefold *sādhana-bhakti*, beginning with hearing, that love for Kṛṣṇa awakens.

(3) The goal to be attained — the prayojana, or fifth goal of life — is love for

Kṛṣṇa —

কৃষ্ণের চরণে হয় যদি অনুরাগ ।
কৃষ্ণ বিনু অন্যত্র তার নাহি রহে রাগ ॥ ১৪৩ ॥

kṛṣṇera caraṇe haya yadi anurāga
Kṛṣṇa's for the feet is if deep attachment
kṛṣṇa vinu anyatra tāra nāhi rahe rāga
Kṛṣṇa except elsewhere his not remains attachment

143 When deep attachment for Kṛṣṇa's feet arises, no attachment to anything other than Kṛṣṇa remains.

পঞ্চম পুরুষার্থ সেই প্রেম-মহাধন ।
কৃষ্ণের মাধুর্য্য-রস করায় আস্বাদন ॥ ১৪৪ ॥

pañcama puruṣārtha sei prema-mahādhana
the fifth goal of life that great treasure of prema
kṛṣṇera mādhurya-rasa karāya āsvādana
Kṛṣṇa's sweetness-rasa makes taste

144 That great treasure of prema is the fifth goal of life; it lets one taste the rasa of Kṛṣṇa's sweetness.

প্রেমা হৈতে কৃষ্ণ হয় নিজভক্তবশ ।
প্রেমা হৈতে পায় কৃষ্ণের সেবা-সুখরস ॥ ১৪৫ ॥

premā haite kṛṣṇa haya nija bhakta-vaśa
prema from Kṛṣṇa becomes to His own devotee subject
premā haite pāya kṛṣṇera sevā-sukha-rasa
prema from one gains Kṛṣṇa's the joy-rasa of service

145 By prema Kṛṣṇa comes under the control of His devotee, and by prema one tastes the joy of serving Kṛṣṇa.

The Brahma-sūtra establishes sambandha, abhidheya and prayojana —

সম্বন্ধ, অভিধেয়, প্রয়োজন-নাম ।
এই তিন অর্থ সর্ব্বসূত্রে পর্য্যবসান ॥ ১৪৬ ॥

sambandha, abhidheya, prayojana-nāma
sambandha abhidheya prayojana by name
ei tina artha sarva-sūtre paryavasāna
these three meanings in all the sūtras the conclusion

146 *Sambandha*, *abhidheya* and *prayojana* — relationship, means and goal: in these three meanings all the sūtras find their conclusion."

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

"Who am I? What is this material universe? What is Bhagavān? And what is our relationship with one another?" When one finds the true answer to these four questions, one has "knowledge of *sambandha*." What is the duty of one who has gained knowledge of *sambandha*? One must understand this, and taking up that duty is to be known as the *abhidheya* of all the scriptures. The fruit one attains by carrying out that duty is called the *prayojana*. The *Brahma-sūtra* teaches precisely these three meanings.

Having heard the explanation of all the sūtras, the sannyāsīs offer praise —

এইমত সর্ব্বসূত্রের ব্যাখ্যান শুনিয়া ।
সকল সন্ন্যাসী কহে বিনয় করিয়া ॥ ১৪৭ ॥

ei-mata sarva-sūtrera vyākhyāna śuniyā
in this way of all the sūtras the explanation hearing
sakala sannyāsī kahe vinaya kariyā
all the sannyāsīs say humility showing

147 Hearing all the sūtras explained in this way, all the sannyāsīs humbly said:

বেদময়-মূর্ত্তি তুমি, — সাক্ষাৎ নারায়ণ ।
ক্ষম অপরাধ, — পূর্ব্বে যে কৈলুঁ নিন্দন ॥ ১৪৮ ॥

vedamaya-mūrti tumi, — sākṣāt nārāyaṇa
made of the Vedas the form You directly Nārāyaṇa
kṣama aparādha, — pūrve ye kailuṁ nindana
forgive the offence before which we made blasphemy

148 "You are the Vedas embodied — Nārāyaṇa Himself. Forgive us for having blasphemed You before."

They constantly take the name of Kṛṣṇa —

সেই হৈতে সন্ন্যাসীর ফিরে গেল মন ।
'কৃষ্ণ' 'কৃষ্ণ' নাম সদা করয়ে গ্রহণ ॥ ১৪৯ ॥

sei haite sannyāsīra phire gela mana
that from of the sannyāsīs turned went the minds
'kṛṣṇa' 'kṛṣṇa' nāma sadā karaye grahaṇa
'Kṛṣṇa' 'Kṛṣṇa' the name always they make taking

149 From that time the sannyāsīs' hearts were changed, and they always took the name "Kṛṣṇa, Kṛṣṇa".

Anubhāṣya.
The leader at that time of the *ekadaṇḍī sannyāsīs* of Śaṅkara's sampradāya living in Kāśī was Śrī Prakāśānanda Sarasvatī. Some mistakenly try to identify him with Śrī Prabodhānanda Sarasvatī, who lived in Śrī Raṅga-kṣetra and later in Kāmyavana. Needless to say, Prabodhānanda was a *tridaṇḍī* of Rāmānuja's line, a *jīyar svāmī*, who had come from the land of Mysore and lived in Raṅga-kṣetra. He is the author of such books as *Śrī Caitanya-candrāmṛta*, *Rādhā-rasa-sudhā-nidhi*, *Saṅgīta-mādhava*, *Vṛndāvana-śataka* and *Navadvīpa-śataka*. Veṅkaṭa Bhaṭṭa, Tirumalaya Bhaṭṭa and Prabodhānanda were three brothers. Mahāprabhu saw him in Śaka 1433, during the *cāturmāsya*, as a member of Rāmānuja's sampradāya; so it is unreasonable to think that in Śaka 1435 He saw him in Kāśī as a member of Śaṅkara's sampradāya. See the book *Śrī Bhakti-ratnākara*.

The Lord forgives their offences and bestows mercy —

এইমতে তাঁ-সবার ক্ষমি' অপরাধ ।
সবাকারে কৃষ্ণনাম করিল প্রসাদ ॥ ১৫০ ॥

ei-mate tāṁ-sabāra kṣami' aparādha
in this way of them all forgiving the offences
sabākāre kṛṣṇa-nāma karila prasāda
to all Kṛṣṇa's name He made grace

150 So He forgave their offences and graced them all with Kṛṣṇa's name.

Together they honour the mahā-prasāda —

তবে সকল সন্ন্যাসী মহাপ্রভুকে লৈয়া ।
ভিক্ষা করিলেন সবে, মধ্যে বসাইয়া ॥ ১৫১ ॥

tabe sakala sannyāsī mahāprabhuke laiyā
then all sannyāsīs Mahāprabhu taking
bhikṣā karilena sabe, madhye vasāiyā
alms took all in the middle seating

151 Then all the sannyāsīs took their meal together with Mahāprabhu, seating Him in their midst.

ভিক্ষা করি' মহাপ্রভু আইলা বাসাঘর ।
হেন চিত্র লীলা করে গৌরাঙ্গ-সুন্দর ॥ ১৫২ ॥

bhikṣā kari' mahāprabhu āilā vāsāghara
alms having taken Mahāprabhu came to His lodging
hena citra līlā kare gaurāṅga-sundara
such wonderful pastime performs the beautiful Gaurāṅga

152 After the meal Mahāprabhu returned to His lodging. Such are the wonderful pastimes of the beautiful Gaurāṅga.

The devotees rejoice at the Lord's magnanimous pastimes —

চন্দ্রশেখর, তপন মিশ্র, আর সনাতন ।
শুনি' দেখি' আনন্দিত সবাকার মন ॥ ১৫৩ ॥

candraśekhara, tapana miśra, āra sanātana
Candraśekhara Tapana Miśra and Sanātana
śuni' dekhi' ānandita sabākāra mana
hearing seeing joyful of all the minds

153 Candraśekhara, Tapana Miśra and Sanātana rejoiced at heart to hear and see all this.

প্রভুকে দেখিতে আইসে সকল সন্ন্যাসী ।
প্রভুর প্রশংসা করে সব বারাণসী ॥ ১৫৪ ॥

prabhuke dekhite āise sakala sannyāsī
the Lord to see come all sannyāsīs
prabhura praśaṁsā kare saba vārāṇasī
the Lord's praise makes all Vārāṇasī

154 All the sannyāsīs came to see the Lord, and all Vārāṇasī sang His praises.

Kāśī is blessed, for the Lord set foot there —

বারাণসীপুরী আইলা শ্রীকৃষ্ণচৈতন্য ।
পুরীসহ সর্ব্বলোক হৈল মহাধন্য ॥ ১৫৫ ॥

vārāṇasī-purī āilā śrī-kṛṣṇa-caitanya
to the city of Vārāṇasī came Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya
purī-saha sarva-loka haila mahā-dhanya
with the city all the people became greatly blessed

155 Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya had come to Vārāṇasī, and the city and all its people were greatly blessed.

Countless people come to see the Lord —

লক্ষ লক্ষ লোক আইসে প্রভুকে দেখিতে ।
মহাভিড় হৈল দ্বারে, নারে প্রবেশিতে ॥ ১৫৬ ॥

lakṣa lakṣa loka āise prabhuke dekhite
hundreds of thousands of people come the Lord to see
mahā-bhiḍa haila dvāre, nāre praveśite
a great crowd formed at the door they cannot enter

156 People came in their hundreds of thousands to see the Lord; there was such a crowd at the door that no one could get in.

প্রভু যবে যা'ন বিশ্বেশ্বর-দরশনে ।
লক্ষ লক্ষ লোক আসি' মিলে সেই স্থানে ॥ ১৫৭ ॥

prabhu yabe yā'na viśveśvara-daraśane
the Lord when goes to see Viśveśvara
lakṣa lakṣa loka āsi' mile sei sthāne
hundreds of thousands of people coming gather at that place

157 Whenever the Lord went to see Viśveśvara, hundreds of thousands of people gathered there.

স্নান করিতে যবে যা'ন গঙ্গাতীরে ।
তাহাঞি সকল লোক হয় মহাভিড়ে ॥ ১৫৮ ॥

snāna karite yabe yā'na gaṅgā-tīre
bath to take when He goes to the bank of the Gaṅgā
tāhāñi sakala loka haya mahā-bhiḍe
there all the people make a great crowd

158 When He went to bathe on the bank of the Gaṅgā, there too all the people thronged in a great crowd.

The Lord delivers the people by making them chant the names of Hari —

বাহু তুলি' প্রভু বলে, — বল হরি হরি ।
হরিধ্বনি করে লোক স্বর্গমর্ত্ত্য ভরি' ॥ ১৫৯ ॥

bāhu tuli' prabhu bale, — bala hari hari
arms raising the Lord says say Hari Hari
hari-dhvani kare loka svarga-martya bhari'
the sound of Hari make the people heaven and earth filling

159 Raising His arms, the Lord would say, "Chant 'Hari! Hari!'", and the people's cry of "Hari!" filled heaven and earth.

The Lord leaves Kāśī and sends Śrī Sanātana to Vṛndāvana —

লোক নিস্তারিয়া প্রভুর চলিতে হৈল মন ।
বৃন্দাবনে পাঠাইলা শ্রীসনাতন ॥ ১৬০ ॥

loka nistāriyā prabhura calite haila mana
the people having delivered the Lord's to depart came the mind
vṛndāvane pāṭhāilā śrī-sanātana
to Vṛndāvana He sent Śrī Sanātana

160 Having delivered the people, the Lord decided to leave, and He sent Śrī Sanātana to Vṛndāvana.

রাত্রি-দিবসে লোকের শুনি' কোলাহল ।
বারাণসী ছাড়ি' প্রভু আইলা নীলাচল ॥ ১৬১ ॥

rātri-divase lokera śuni' kolāhala
night and day of the people hearing the clamour
vārāṇasī chāḍi' prabhu āilā nīlācala
Vārāṇasī leaving the Lord came to Nīlācala

161 Hearing the clamour of the crowds night and day, the Lord left Vārāṇasī and returned to Nīlācala.

এই লীলা কহিব আগে বিস্তার করিয়া ।
সংক্ষেপে কহিলাঙ ইহাঁ প্রসঙ্গ পাইয়া ॥ ১৬২ ॥

ei līlā kahiba āge vistāra kariyā
this pastime I shall tell later in detail making
saṅkṣepe kahilāṅa ihāṁ prasaṅga pāiyā
briefly I have told here the occasion finding

162 I shall tell these pastimes in detail later; here I have told them briefly, as the occasion arose.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
"Later": see Madhya, Chapter 25.

Thus ends the seventh chapter of the "Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya."

The Lord, in the form of the Pañca-tattva, delivers the world —

এই পঞ্চতত্ত্বরূপে শ্রীকৃষ্ণচৈতন্য ।
কৃষ্ণ-নাম-প্রেম দিয়া বিশ্ব কৈল ধন্য ॥ ১৬৩ ॥

ei pañca-tattva-rūpe śrī-kṛṣṇa-caitanya
in this form of the Pañca-tattva Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya
kṛṣṇa-nāma-prema diyā viśva kaila dhanya
Kṛṣṇa's name and prema giving the world made blessed

163 Thus, in the form of the Pañca-tattva, Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya blessed the whole world, giving everyone Kṛṣṇa's name and love for Him.

The Lord, Himself and through His preachers, spreads the name and prema throughout India and delivers the people —

মথুরাতে পাঠাইল রূপ-সনাতন ।
দুই সেনাপতি কৈল ভক্তি প্রচারণ ॥ ১৬৪ ॥

mathurāte pāṭhāila rūpa-sanātana
to Mathurā He sent Rūpa and Sanātana
dui senā-pati kaila bhakti pracāraṇa
the two generals made of bhakti spreading

164 He sent Rūpa and Sanātana to Mathurā, and these two commanders spread bhakti there.

নিত্যানন্দ-গোসাঞে পাঠাইলা গৌড়দেশে ।
তেঁহো ভক্তি প্রচারিলা অশেষ-বিশেষে ॥ ১৬৫ ॥

nityānanda-gosāñe pāṭhāilā gauḍa-deśe
Nityānanda Gosāñi He sent to the land of Gauḍa
teṁho bhakti pracārilā aśeṣa-viśeṣe
He bhakti preached in every possible way

165 He sent Nityānanda Gosāñi to the land of Gauḍa, and there He preached bhakti in every possible way.

আপনে দক্ষিণ দেশ করিলা গমন ।
গ্রামে গ্রামে কৈলা কৃষ্ণনাম প্রচারণ ॥ ১৬৬ ॥

āpane dakṣiṇa deśa karilā gamana
Himself to the southern country made going
grāme grāme kailā kṛṣṇa-nāma pracāraṇa
in village in village He made of Kṛṣṇa's name spreading

166 He Himself went to the south and spread Kṛṣṇa's name from village to village.

সেতুবন্ধ পর্য্যন্ত কৈল ভক্তির প্রচার ।
কৃষ্ণপ্রেম দিয়া কৈল সবার নিস্তার ॥ ১৬৭ ॥

setubandha paryanta kaila bhaktira pracāra
Setubandha as far as He made of bhakti preaching
kṛṣṇa-prema diyā kaila sabāra nistāra
Kṛṣṇa-prema giving He made of all deliverance

167 As far as Setubandha He preached bhakti, and, giving Kṛṣṇa-prema, He delivered everyone.

Anubhāṣya.
To deliver everyone throughout India through love for Kṛṣṇa, [Mahāprabhu] spread the name of Kṛṣṇa: in the northwest, in the Māthura-maṇḍala, through Śrī Rūpa and Sanātana; in Gauḍa and Bengal through Śrī Nityānanda; and Himself in the south, village after village, as far as Setubandha.

By hearing the explanation of the Pañca-tattva one gains knowledge of the Gaura-tattva —

এই ত' কহিল পঞ্চতত্ত্বের ব্যাখ্যান ।
ইহার শ্রবণে হয় চৈতন্যতত্ত্ব-জ্ঞান ॥ ১৬৮ ॥

ei ta' kahila pañca-tattvera vyākhyāna
thus indeed I have told of the Pañca-tattva the explanation
ihāra śravaṇe haya caitanya-tattva-jñāna
of this by hearing comes of Caitanya's truth knowledge

168 Thus I have given the explanation of the Pañca-tattva; by hearing it one comes to know the truth of Caitanya.

Anubhāṣya.
Thus ends the seventh chapter of the "Anubhāṣya."

শ্রীচৈতন্য, নিত্যানন্দ, অদ্বৈত, — তিন জন ।
শ্রীবাস-গদাধর-আদি যত ভক্তগণ ॥ ১৬৯ ॥

śrī-caitanya, nityānanda, advaita, — tina jana
Śrī Caitanya Nityānanda Advaita three persons
śrīvāsa-gadādhara-ādi yata bhakta-gaṇa
Śrīvāsa Gadādhara and others all devotees

169 Śrī Caitanya, Nityānanda and Advaita — the three; Śrīvāsa, Gadādhara and all the other devotees —

সবাকার পাদপদ্মে কোটি নমস্কার ।
যৈছে তৈছে কহি কিছু চৈতন্য-বিহার ॥ ১৭০ ॥

sabākāra pādapadme koṭi namaskāra
of all at the lotus feet millions of obeisances
yaiche taiche kahi kichu caitanya-vihāra
somehow I tell something of Caitanya's pastimes

170 at the lotus feet of all of them I bow millions of times, and as best I can I tell something of Caitanya's pastimes.

শ্রীরূপ-রঘুনাথ-পদে যার আশ ।
চৈতন্যচরিতামৃত কহে কৃষ্ণদাস ॥ ১৭১ ॥

śrī-rūpa-raghunātha-pade yāra āśa
Śrī Rūpa's, Raghunātha's at the feet whose hope
caitanya-caritāmṛta kahe kṛṣṇadāsa
"Caitanya-caritāmṛta" narrates Kṛṣṇadāsa

171 Praying at the feet of Śrī Rūpa and Śrī Raghunātha, I, Kṛṣṇadāsa, narrate the *Caitanya-caritāmṛta*.

Notes

1. According to the *Anubhāṣya*: the devotee in form is Śrī Gaurāṅga, who tastes His own sweetness; the devotee in essence (in the form of His brother) is Śrī Nityānanda; the devotee-avatāra is Śrī Advaita; the one called a devotee is Śrīvāsa and others, established in *śānta*, *dāsya* and the other rasas; the potency is Gadādhara, Svarūpa Dāmodara, Rāmānanda and others. The same verse as Ādi 1.14; ascribed in the edition to Śrī Rūpa Gosvāmī. ↩
2. As in the Gauḍīya Maṭha edition: «কোটীসূর্য্যাভাস» (another reading: «কোটিসূর্য্যাভাস»); the sense is the same. ↩
3. As in the Gauḍīya Maṭha edition: «ব্রহ্মাদি আনন্দ» ("the bliss of Brahman and the rest"; the heading: "Prema, which puts liberation and the rest to shame, is the fifth goal of life"). Other editions read «মোক্ষাদি» ("liberation and the rest"). ↩
4. As in the Gauḍīya Maṭha edition: «তাহা» ("it"; another reading «যাহা», "which"); the sense is the same. ↩
5. From these words on, the edition prints the heading *Anubhāṣya* above the continuation — apparently a typesetting error, since the text continues the sentence of the *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*. ↩
6. *Śvetāśvatara Upaniṣad* 6.8. ↩
7. So in the edition. In Ādi 6.4 the subheading attributes the neighbouring verses (12–13) to the diary of Śrī Svarūpa Gosvāmī. ↩
8. *Kaṭha Upaniṣad* 2.2.13; *Śvetāśvatara Upaniṣad* 6.13. ↩
9. Śaṅkara, *Kaupīna-pañcaka* 1. ↩
10. *Śrī Śikṣāṣṭaka* 3. ↩
11. *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 3.33.7. ↩
12. *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 1.7.6. ↩

13. *Chāndogya Upaniṣad* 6.2.1. ↩
14. *Chāndogya Upaniṣad* 3.14.1. ↩
15. So in the edition's Bengali paraphrase, and also in the Sanskrit text of the quotation above (*adhika-sāmarthye 'labdhe*, with an avagraha — the same sign as in *nāmato 'pi* beside it). The other reading (*labdhe*, "since mantras obtain greater power") is also possible in sense, but the edition does not have it. ↩
16. *Śrī Nāmāṣṭaka* 1. ↩
17. Unclear place in the scan: instead of the book's title the edition has "***"; apparently the same *Prīti-sandarbha*. ↩
18. *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 10.33.30. ↩
19. *Bhakti-rasāmṛta-sindhu* 1.2.255. ↩
20. *Śvetāśvatara Upaniṣad* 6.23. ↩
21. The edition reads *śaḥ bhāḥ* 3.3.32; apparently Śaṅkara's commentary on *Brahma-sūtra* 3.3.32, which mentions Apāntaratamā, the ancient teacher of the Vedas. ↩
22. *Muktikā Upaniṣad* 1.30–39. Many names in the verse are abbreviated (e.g., "Tāpanī" for the *Nṛsiṁha-tāpanī*); they are given as in the edition. ↩
23. *Bhagavad-gītā* 7.14. ↩
24. From these words on, the edition prints the heading *Anubhāṣya* above the continuation — apparently a typesetting error, since the text continues the sentence of the *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*. ↩
25. A play on words: śūdra is explained as "one who grieves" (from the root *śuc*, to grieve). ↩
26. Apparently this is an opponent's objection; the reply to it is omitted in the edition (***). ↩